

SS1 CATERING AND CRAFT PRACTICE LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO CATERING CRAFT

1. ORIGIN OF CATERING CRAFT



"Catering" refers to the business of providing food and beverage services. The word itself comes from the French word '*acater*,' meaning 'to buy' or 'to provide.' The history of catering is the history of hospitality itself.

- **Ancient Times:** In ancient Greece and Rome, "inns" (called *tabernae*) were established along travel routes. They primarily served as places for travelers to rest and buy simple food and wine. Feasting and banqueting were also central to political and social life, requiring skilled cooks and servers.
- **Medieval Period (Middle Ages):** The rise of monasteries and abbeys made them the first major hospitality centers, offering food and lodging to pilgrims and travelers. In towns, **guilds** (associations of craftsmen) were formed, including guilds for bakers and "innkeepers." The "inn" or "tavern" became a central part of community life.
- **The Birth of the Restaurant (1700s, France):** The modern concept of catering was born in Paris. In 1765, a man named **Boulanger** opened a shop selling '*soups*' (restoratives, from which the word "restaurant" comes). Unlike inns, he offered a *choice* of dishes from a menu at individual tables.
- **The French Revolution (1789):** This event was a major catalyst. Chefs who worked for the aristocracy in noble houses were suddenly unemployed. They opened their own high-quality "restaurants" for the public.
- **The Great Chefs:**
 - **Marie-Antoine Carême (Early 1800s):** Known as the "King of Chefs and Chef of Kings." He standardized *haute cuisine* (high-quality cooking), emphasizing elaborate presentation and complex sauces.
 - **Georges Auguste Escoffier (Late 1800s/Early 1900s):** The "father of modern catering." He simplified Carême's complex style and, most importantly, created the **Kitchen Brigade system** (*Brigade de Cuisine*). This organized the professional kitchen into a hierarchy with specific roles (e.g., *Saucier* for sauces, *Garde Manger* for cold food, *Pâtissier* for pastry), which is still the model used today.
- **Modern Era:** The Industrial Revolution led to "industrial catering" (feeding factory workers). The invention of cars, trains, and planes led to "transport catering." Today, catering is a massive, diverse industry covering everything from a local fast-food-joint to luxury hotel banqueting.

2. CAREERS IN CATERING CRAFT

Catering craft offers a vast and growing range of career opportunities. These careers can be broadly divided into different sectors and roles.

A. SECTORS OF THE CATERING INDUSTRY

1. **Hospitality Sector:** This is the largest, focused on profit.
 - *Examples:* Hotels, restaurants, bars, cafes, nightclubs, event catering.
2. **Institutional/Welfare Sector:** This is subsidized and focuses on service.
 - *Examples:* School catering, hospital catering, canteens (in factories or offices), prison catering.
3. **Transport Sector:** Provides food for travelers.
 - *Examples:* Airline catering, cruise ship catering, railway catering.
4. **Armed Forces Sector:** Provides food for the military in barracks or in the field.

B. KEY CAREER ROLES

1. **Food Production (The Kitchen):**
 - **Chef de Cuisine (Executive Chef):** The manager of the kitchen. Responsible for menu planning, costing, staff management, and quality control.
 - **Sous Chef (Deputy Chef):** The second-in-command. Manages the kitchen in the Executive Chef's absence.
 - **Chef de Partie (Station Chef):** Manages a specific *section* of the kitchen, such as:
 - *Saucier:* Sauce chef.
 - *Poissonnier:* Fish chef.
 - *Rôtisseur:* Roast chef.
 - *Garde Manger:* Cold kitchen chef (salads, appetizers).
 - *Pâtissier:* Pastry chef.
 - **Commis Chef (Apprentice):** A trainee chef working under a Chef de Partie.
 - **Kitchen Porter:** Cleans the kitchen and equipment.
2. **Food and Beverage (F&B) Service (The Front-of-House):**
 - **F&B Manager:** Manages all F&B outlets in a large establishment (e.g., all restaurants and bars in a hotel).
 - **Restaurant Manager (Maître d'Hôtel):** Responsible for the overall service in the restaurant.

- **Sommelier (Wine Waiter):** A trained expert in wine. Recommends and serves wine.
 - **Head Waiter (Chef de Rang):** Manages a team of waiters in a specific section of the restaurant.
 - **Waiter/Waitress (Serveur/Serveuse):** Takes orders, serves food, and clears tables.
3. **Specialized and Management Careers:**
- **Caterer (Owner):** An entrepreneur who owns and runs their own catering business (e.g., event catering).
 - **Food Stylist:** Prepares and arranges food to look perfect for photography in magazines, adverts, and films.
 - **Food Critic/Journalist:** Writes reviews about restaurants and food for newspapers or websites.
 - **Nutritionist/Dietitian:** Works in hospitals or schools to plan menus that meet specific health requirements.
 - **Catering/Hospitality Lecturer:** Teaches catering craft in a college or vocational school.

EVALUATION

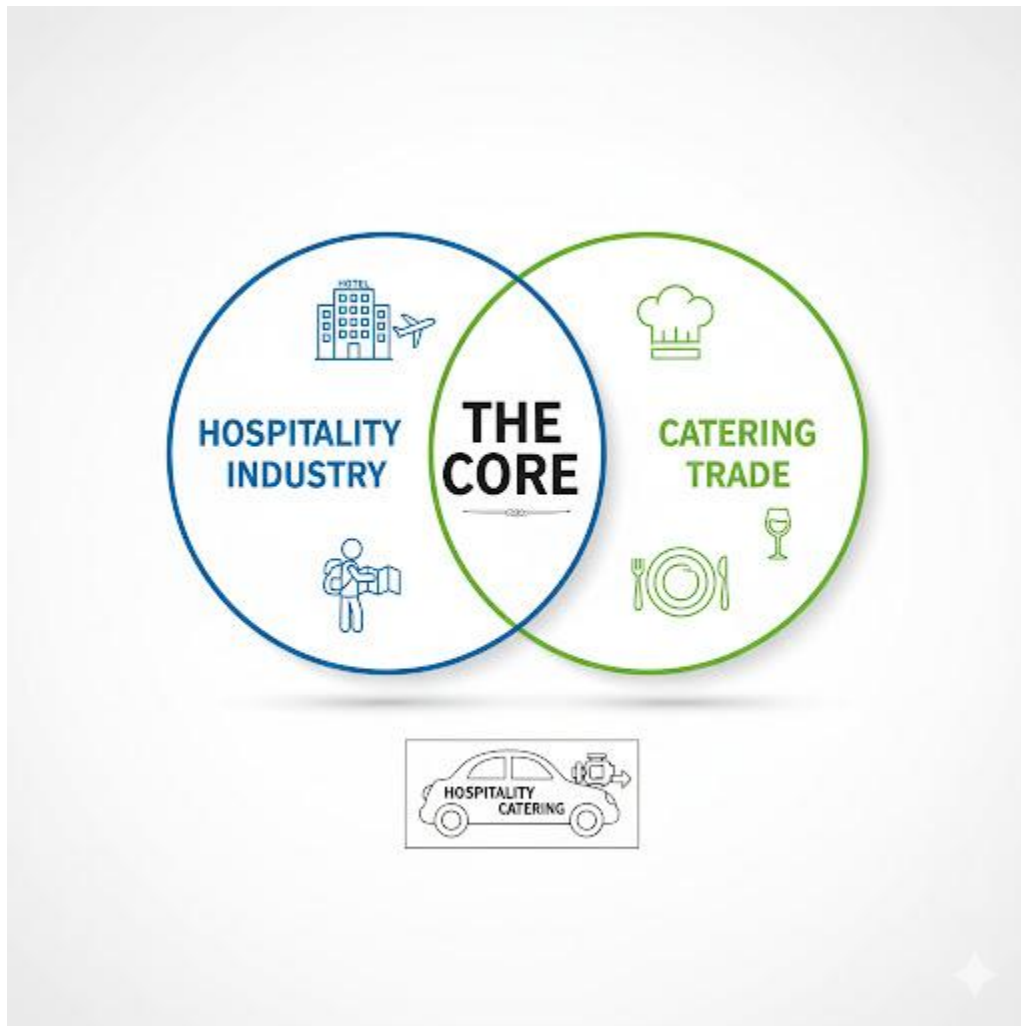
1. Who is known as the "father of modern catering," and what was his most important contribution?
2. What is the difference between *haute cuisine* and a *restaurant*?
3. List the three main sectors of the catering industry and give one example of a job in each.
4. Describe the roles of a *Garde Manger*, a *Sommelier*, and a *Sous Chef*.

ASSIGNMENT

Draw the Kitchen Brigade hierarchy as created by Auguste Escoffier, showing the *Executive Chef* at the top, the *Sous Chef* below, and at least four *Chefs de Partie* with their specific responsibilities.

WEEK 2: HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY IN CATERING

1. DEFINITION OF HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY



The term "Hospitality" comes from the Latin word *'hospes,'* which means both "host" and "guest."

Hospitality is the act of cordially and generously receiving and entertaining guests, visitors, or strangers.

The **Hospitality Industry** is a broad category of businesses and services dedicated to providing **accommodation, food, and beverage** to people who are away from home. It is a **service-based industry** where the primary "product" is an experience of comfort, care, and well-being.

2. RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY AND CATERING TRADE

This is a very important distinction. They are deeply related but not the same thing.

Catering is the provision of food and beverages (the tangible product).

Hospitality is the service, atmosphere, and experience that surrounds the product.

You can have catering *without* hospitality (e.g., a basic factory canteen that just serves food), but you cannot have a hospitality industry *without* catering. Catering is the **largest and most vital component** of the hospitality industry.

Analogy: If the Hospitality Industry is a car, then Catering (F&B) is the engine, and Accommodation (Lodging) is the body. You need both to have a functional car, but the engine is the core part that provides the "fuel" (food) for the guest.

3. CLASSIFICATION AND COMPONENTS OF HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY

The industry is vast and can be classified into four main sectors.

A. CLASSIFICATION (SECTORS)

1. **ACCOMMODATION (LODGING):** Provides a place to sleep.
 - **Hotels:** Offer accommodation, F&B, and other services.
 - **Motels:** (Motor-Hotels) Located on roadsides, primarily for motorists.
 - **Inns:** Smaller, often in the countryside, offering rooms and food.
 - **Hostels:** Budget-oriented, with shared rooms (dormitories).
 - **Resorts:** Offer accommodation plus a wide range of recreational facilities (beach, spa, golf).
 - **Guest Houses/Bed & Breakfast (B&Bs):** Small, often family-run homes offering a room and breakfast.
2. **FOOD & BEVERAGE (F&B) / CATERING:** Provides food and drink.

- **Restaurants:** (Fine dining, casual, fast food).
- **Cafes:** Coffee, tea, and light snacks.
- **Bars & Pubs:** Primarily serve alcoholic beverages.
- **Catering Services:** Event catering, institutional catering.
- **Nightclubs:** Entertainment, drinks, and simple food.
- 3. **TRAVEL & TOURISM:** Focuses on moving people and providing entertainment.
 - **Airlines, Cruise Ships, Railways:** (Which also have their own catering).
 - **Travel Agencies & Tour Operators:** Plan and book trips.
 - **Tourist Attractions:** (Museums, theme parks, national parks).
- 4. **RECREATION:** Focuses on leisure activities.
 - **Clubs:** (Sports clubs, country clubs).
 - **Parks & Leisure Centres:** (Pools, gyms).
 - **Entertainment Venues:** (Cinemas, theatres).

B. COMPONENTS (FUNCTIONAL DEPARTMENTS)

Within a single large establishment (like a hotel), the industry is made up of functional components or departments:

1. **Food Production:** The kitchen (chefs).
2. **Food & Beverage Service:** The restaurant and bar (waiters, sommeliers).
3. **Accommodation / Rooms Division:**
 - *Front Office:* Manages reservations, check-in/out, and guest services.
 - *Housekeeping:* Responsible for cleaning guest rooms and public areas.
4. **Sales & Marketing:** Sells the hotel's services to groups and individuals.
5. **Administration:** Human Resources, Accounting, and general management.

EVALUATION

1. Define the term "Hospitality" and explain its origin.

2. In your own words, what is the *key difference* between the "Hospitality Industry" and the "Catering Trade"?
3. List the four main sectors of the hospitality industry.
4. Which sector does a "Hostel" belong to, and how is it different from a "Hotel"?

ASSIGNMENT

Write a 200-word essay on the topic: "Why is Catering considered the most important component of the Hospitality Industry?"

WEEK 3: IMPORTANCE AND CHARACTERISTICS OF HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY

1. IMPORTANCE OF HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY

The hospitality industry is a major economic and social force, both locally and globally.



A. ECONOMIC IMPORTANCE

1. **Employment Generation:** The industry is highly **labour-intensive**. It creates millions of jobs, from highly skilled (Executive Chefs, Hotel Managers) to semi-skilled (waiters, housekeepers) and unskilled (cleaners, porters).

2. **Foreign Exchange Earnings:** When international tourists visit a country, they spend money (foreign currency) on hotels, food, and tours. This brings valuable foreign currency into the country's economy, improving its balance of payments.
3. **Contribution to Gross Domestic Product (GDP):** The total value of all services (rooms sold, meals served) contributes significantly to a nation's GDP.
4. **Infrastructure Development:** To support tourism and hospitality, governments and private companies build better infrastructure (airports, roads, electricity, water supply) that benefits the entire population.
5. **The "Multiplier Effect":** The industry supports many other industries. For example, a hotel buys food from **farmers**, furniture from **manufacturers**, and laundry services from **local businesses**. This spending "multiplies" throughout the economy.
6. **Tax Revenue:** The government collects significant revenue from taxes on hotel rooms, restaurant meals, and employee salaries.

B. SOCIAL AND CULTURAL IMPORTANCE

1. **Cultural Exchange:** It promotes understanding between people from different cultures. Guests learn about the host country's customs, and staff learn about their international guests.
2. **Preservation of Culture and Heritage:** The industry creates a market for local arts, crafts, music, and dance. It also helps preserve and promote local cuisine, turning it into a tourist attraction.
3. **Improved Social Life:** It provides venues (restaurants, clubs, event halls) for local people to socialize, celebrate, and relax.
4. **National Image:** A strong hospitality industry gives a country a positive, welcoming, and professional image on the world stage.

2. CHARACTERISTICS OF HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY

The "product" of the hospitality industry is *service*. This service has four unique characteristics that make it different from physical goods (like a car or a phone).

1. **INTANGIBILITY:**

- **Meaning:** The hospitality product cannot be touched, seen, or held before it is purchased. You cannot "test-drive" a hotel stay.
 - **Impact:** Guests buy a *promise* of a good experience. Therefore, the industry must rely on **brand reputation, good reviews, and tangible clues** (like a clean lobby or a professional uniform) to build trust.
2. **INSEPARABILITY (OR SIMULTANEITY):**
- **Meaning:** The service is **produced and consumed at the exact same time**. The *service provider* (e.g., a waiter) is part of the product.
 - **Impact:** A guest's experience is inseparable from the person who delivers it. You can't separate the meal from the waiter who serves it. This makes **staff training and attitude** extremely important.
3. **PERISHABILITY:**
- **Meaning:** The product cannot be saved, stored, or resold for later. It is "perishable."
 - **Impact:** An empty hotel room for one night, an unsold airline seat, or an empty restaurant table represents **100% lost revenue** that can never be recovered. This is why hotels and airlines use "dynamic pricing" and "last-minute deals" to try and sell every last "unit" of inventory.
4. **VARIABILITY (OR HETEROGENEITY):**
- **Meaning:** The quality of the service can be inconsistent and *varies* depending on **who** provides it, **when** it is provided, and **to whom** it is provided.
 - **Impact:** A waiter might be cheerful in the morning but tired and slow by the end of a long shift. The *same* chef might cook a dish perfectly one day and imperfectly the next. To fight this, the industry relies on **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), training, and quality control** to ensure consistency.

EVALUATION

1. Define the "Multiplier Effect" in the context of the hospitality industry.
2. List three economic and two social/cultural importances of the industry.
3. Explain the characteristic of "Perishability." Give a clear example.
4. Why does "Inseparability" make staff training so important?

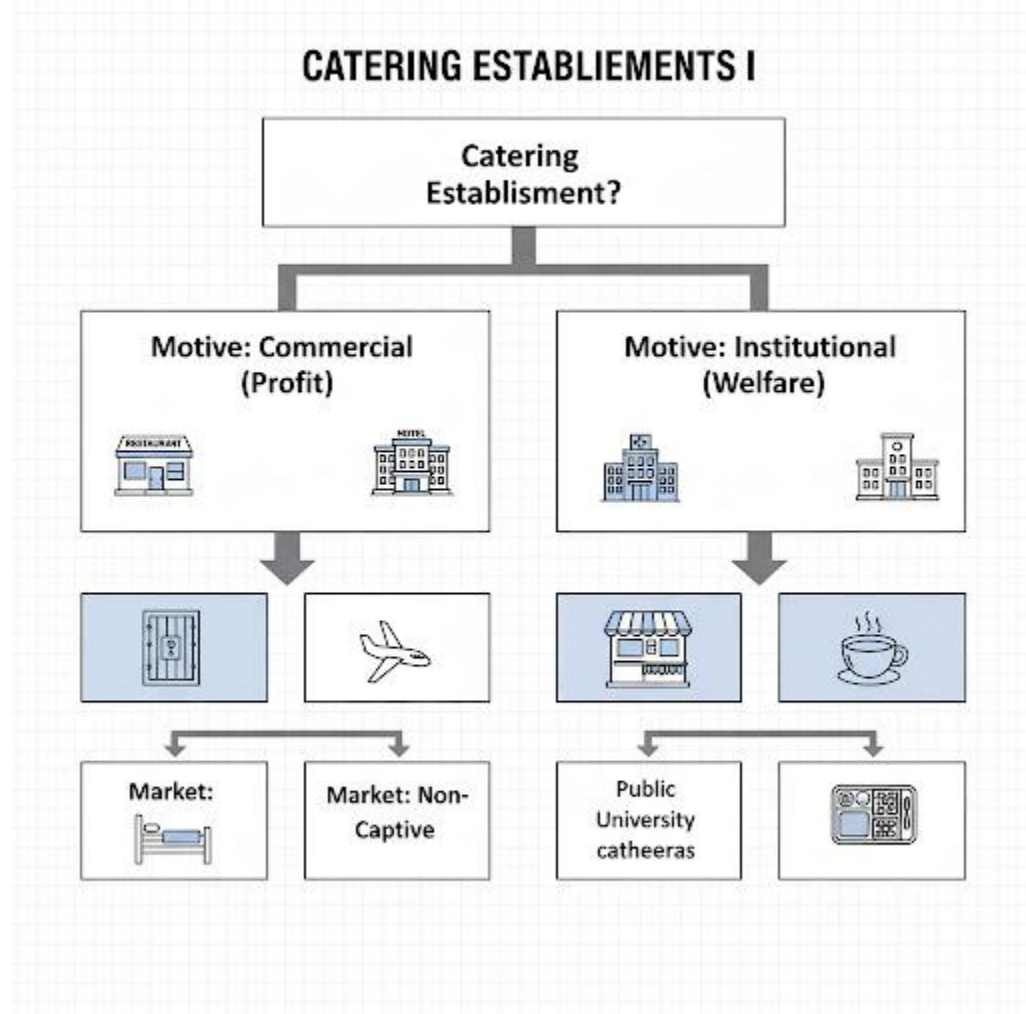
ASSIGNMENT

Choose one of the four characteristics of the hospitality industry (Intangibility, Inseparability, Perishability, or Variability). Write a 250-word essay explaining this characteristic and what a hotel manager can do to manage the *problems* it creates.

WEEK 4: CATERING ESTABLISHMENTS I

1. CLASSIFICATION OF CATERING ESTABLISHMENTS

A **catering establishment** is any business or organization that provides food and beverage. We can classify these establishments based on their *motive* (why they exist) and their *market* (who they serve).



A. CLASSIFICATION BY MOTIVE

1. COMMERCIAL (OR PROFIT-ORIENTED):

- **Motive:** The primary goal is to **make a profit**.
- **Operation:** They are run as private businesses. The price of food and drink is set to cover all costs (food, staff, rent) and generate a surplus (profit).

- **Examples:** Restaurants, hotels, bars, event caterers.

2. INSTITUTIONAL (OR WELFARE/SUBSIDIZED):

- **Motive:** The primary goal is **service and welfare**, not profit.
- **Operation:** They are run by an organization (like a government, a school, or a company) for the benefit of its "members." The food is often **subsidized**, meaning the customer pays a very low price or nothing at all.
- **Examples:** School canteens, hospital catering, prison catering, military mess halls.

B. CLASSIFICATION BY MARKET

1. NON-CAPTIVE MARKET (GENERAL PUBLIC):

- **Market:** The customers are the general public.
- **Choice:** Customers have a *choice* of where to eat.
- **Impact:** These establishments must compete with each other on price, quality, service, and location.
- **Examples:** A restaurant on the high street, a hotel, a fast-food outlet.

2. CAPTIVE MARKET (RESTRICTED):

- **Market:** The customers are "captive," meaning they have *no choice* or *limited choice* of where to eat.
- **Impact:** The establishment does not face direct competition. (This often applies to institutional catering).
- **Examples:** Passengers on an airplane, patients in a hospital, students in a boarding school, workers in a remote factory.

2. TYPES OF CATERING ESTABLISHMENTS

Here is a detailed breakdown of the different types, grouped by their primary classification.

A. COMMERCIAL (PROFIT-ORIENTED) ESTABLISHMENTS

1. **Hotels:** Their main business is accommodation, but F&B is a key part of their service and profit.
2. **Restaurants:** Establishments that cook and serve food to customers on-site.

- **Fine Dining:** Very high quality, high prices, formal service, complex menus.
- **Casual Dining:** Mid-range prices, relaxed atmosphere, full table service.
- **Quick Service Restaurant (QSR) / Fast Food:** Low prices, fast service, limited menu, often self-service (e.g., Mr. Bigg's, Tantalizers).
- **Café/Coffee Shop:** Focuses on drinks, light snacks, cakes.
- 3. **Bars & Pubs:** Primarily serve alcoholic beverages, but may also serve food ('*bar snacks*' or '*pub grub*').
- 4. **Outdoor Catering (Event Caterers):** They do not have a fixed location. They take food, equipment, and staff to a *specific venue* chosen by the client (e.g., weddings, parties, conferences).
- 5. **Transport Catering:**
 - **Airline Catering:** Highly specialized; food is pre-cooked and chilled on the ground, then reheated on the plane.
 - **Railway Catering:** Can range from snack trolleys to full-service restaurant cars.
 - **Cruise Ship Catering:** A major operation, often including multiple restaurants, buffets, and 24-hour service for a captive market.
- 6. **Clubs:** Private establishments (like country clubs or social clubs) that provide F&B only for their members.

B. INSTITUTIONAL (WELFARE/SUBSIDIZED) ESTABLISHMENTS

1. **Industrial Catering:** Provides food for employees in a factory or office. The goal is to provide a nutritious, low-cost meal to keep the workforce healthy and productive.
2. **Educational Catering:** Provides food in schools, colleges, and universities. This ranges from free school meals (government-funded) to "pay-as-you-eat" cafeterias.
3. **Hospital Catering:** A highly specialized area. Menus must cater to the specific **dietary and medical needs** of patients (e.g., low-salt, soft-food, diabetic-friendly) as well as feeding staff and visitors.
4. **Armed Forces Catering:** Provides food for soldiers, sailors, and air force personnel, both in permanent bases (mess halls) and in combat zones (ration packs).
5. **Prison Catering:** Provides basic, nutritious, and low-cost meals to inmates, operating on a very strict budget.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between a *commercial* and an *institutional* catering establishment?
2. Explain what a "captive market" is and give two examples.
3. What is "Outdoor Catering," and how does it differ from a restaurant?
4. Why is hospital catering considered "highly specialized"?

ASSIGNMENT

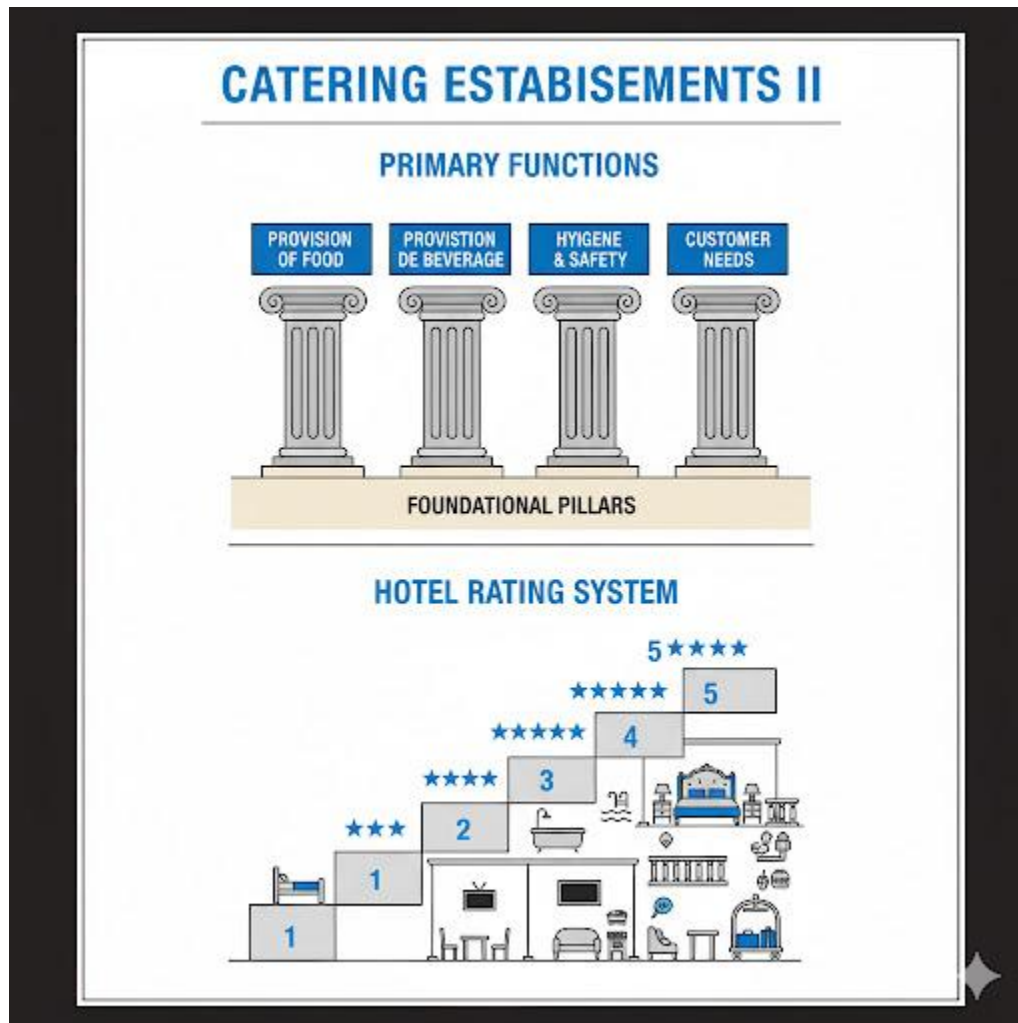
Create a table. In the first column, list the following five establishments: (a) A 5-Star Hotel, (b) A University Cafeteria, (c) A Wedding Caterer, (d) A Prison, (e) A Fast-Food Outlet.

In the next two columns, classify each one by its Motive (Commercial or Institutional) and its Market (Captive or Non-Captive).

WEEK 6: CATERING ESTABLISHMENTS II

1. FUNCTIONS OF CATERING ESTABLISHMENTS

Catering establishments, regardless of their type, perform several key functions. These can be divided into primary (core) functions and secondary (additional) functions.



A. PRIMARY FUNCTIONS (CORE RESPONSIBILITIES)

1. **Provision of Food:** This involves the entire process of **menu planning, sourcing ingredients (purchasing), storing food safely, and preparing (cooking) it.**
2. **Provision of Beverage:** This involves the **selection, purchasing, storage, and service** of all drinks, both alcoholic (beer, wine) and non-alcoholic (water, juice, soft drinks, coffee).

3. **Hygienic and Safe Service:** This is a critical function. The establishment is legally and morally responsible for ensuring that all food and beverages are prepared and served in a **clean environment** (sanitation) by **clean staff** (hygiene) to prevent food poisoning and contamination.
4. **Meeting Customer Needs:** This involves providing **good service** (polite, efficient staff), a **comfortable atmosphere** (ambiance), and **good value** for money, all while meeting the specific expectations of the target customer.

B. SECONDARY FUNCTIONS (ADDITIONAL SERVICES)

These functions are not found in *all* establishments but are common in larger ones, like hotels, to increase revenue and guest satisfaction.

1. **Provision of Accommodation:** Providing guest rooms (the primary function of a hotel, but secondary for the industry as a whole).
2. **Conference and Banqueting:** Providing rooms, equipment (projectors, sound systems), and F&B for large groups (meetings, weddings, conferences).
3. **Entertainment and Recreation:** Providing facilities such as nightclubs, swimming pools, spas, gyms, or live music.
4. **Other Services:** This can include laundry, room service, business centers, and concierge services (booking tours, etc.).

2. HOTEL RATING

Hotel Rating is a system used to classify and grade hotels based on their overall **quality, cleanliness, and range of facilities and services**. This helps guests understand what to expect and allows hotels to justify their prices.

The most common system worldwide is the **Star Rating System (1-Star to 5-Star)**.

- **ONE-STAR (★):**
 - **Description:** Basic, "budget" accommodation.

- **Facilities:** Limited range of services. Rooms are basic (bed, bathroom). F&B may be very limited or non-existent.
- **Target:** Budget travelers, backpackers.
- **TWO-STAR (★★):**
 - **Description:** "Value" or "economy." Still budget-friendly but offers more.
 - **Facilities:** Clean, comfortable rooms with basics like a TV. May have a small, simple restaurant or cafe serving breakfast.
 - **Target:** Travelers looking for a clean, safe place to sleep.
- **THREE-STAR (★★★):**
 - **Description:** "Mid-range" or "standard." Offers a good level of comfort and service.
 - **Facilities:** More spacious rooms, well-decorated. Usually has a full-service restaurant, bar, and may have a business center or small pool.
 - **Target:** Business travelers, families on holiday.
- **FOUR-STAR (★★★★):**
 - **Description:** "First-class" or "superior." High standard of comfort and service.
 - **Facilities:** Large, well-furnished rooms. Multiple restaurants and bars, room service, concierge, swimming pool, gym, conference facilities.
 - **Target:** Business executives, tourists seeking high quality.
- **FIVE-STAR (★★★★★):**
 - **Description:** "Luxury." The highest standard of accommodation and service.
 - **Facilities:** Luxurious rooms and public areas. Gourmet restaurants, 24-hour room service, spa, valet parking, and a very high staff-to-guest ratio for personalized service.
 - **Target:** Wealthy individuals, celebrities, state guests.

Note: There are unofficial "ratings" like **6-Star** or **7-Star** (e.g., Burj Al Arab in Dubai) used in marketing, but these are not part of the formal international system. They are simply terms used to describe luxury that goes far beyond the 5-Star standard.

EVALUATION

1. List the four primary functions of any catering establishment.

2. What is the difference between a *primary* and a *secondary* function? Give one example of each.
3. What is the purpose of the Hotel Rating system?
4. Describe the key differences you would expect to find between a 2-Star and a 4-Star hotel.

ASSIGNMENT

You are a hotel inspector. Write a 250-word report on a fictional "3-Star" hotel. Describe what facilities and services you would *expect* to find to confirm its 3-Star rating.

WEEK 8: CULINARY TERMS

1. COMMONLY USED CULINARY TERMS

The language of the professional kitchen is historically **French**. This is because of the foundational work of French chefs like Carême and Escoffier (see Week 1), who standardized modern cooking. Knowing these terms is essential for understanding recipes and kitchen operations.



2. GLOSSARY OF CULINARY TERMS

The terms can be grouped by their function: preparation, cooking, and service.

A. PREPARATION TERMS (MISE EN PLACE)

- **Mise en Place** (meez-on-plahs): "Everything in its place." The process of preparing and organizing all ingredients (chopping vegetables, measuring spices) *before* cooking begins.
- **Julienne** (joo-lee-en): To cut food (usually vegetables) into long, very thin strips (like matchsticks).
- **Brunoise** (broo-nwaz): To cut food into very small dice (about 3mm).
- **Macédoine** (ma-say-dwan): To cut food into medium dice (about 5-8mm).
- **Chiffonade** (shif-on-ahd): To cut leafy greens or herbs into fine shreds or ribbons.
- **Blanch**: To briefly submerge food in boiling water and then "shock" it in ice water. This stops the cooking, sets the color (for green vegetables), or loosens skins (for tomatoes).
- **Marinade**: A seasoned liquid (often with acid like vinegar or oil) used to soak food (especially meat) to add flavor and tenderize it.

B. COOKING TERMS

- **Sauté** (saw-tay): To cook food quickly in a small amount of hot fat (oil or butter) in a shallow pan, tossing or "jumping" it.
- **Poach**: To cook food gently in a liquid (water, milk, stock) that is just below boiling point (simmering). Used for delicate items like eggs or fish.
- **Braise**: A combination method. First, the food (usually tough meat) is *seared* (browned) in fat, then it is cooked *slowly* in a small amount of liquid in a covered pot (e.Example: pot roast).
- **Flambé** (flom-bay): To add alcohol (like brandy) to a hot pan and ignite it, burning off the alcohol and leaving the flavor.
- **Roux** (roo): A mixture of equal parts cooked flour and fat (usually butter). It is the base used to thicken sauces like Béchamel and Velouté.
- **Bain-marie** (ban-ma-ree): A "water bath." A container of food is placed in a larger pan of hot water. This gently cooks the food or keeps it warm without burning it (e.Example: for custard).
- **Au Jus** (oh-zhoo): Meat served with its own natural cooking juices (not a thickened gravy).

C. SERVICE AND MENU TERMS

- **À la carte** (ah-la-kart): "From the card." A menu where every item (appetizer, main, dessert) is listed and priced *separately*.
- **Table d'hôte** (tah-bluh-doh): "Table of the host." A "set menu" or "fixed-price menu" where the guest gets a set number of courses (e.g., appetizer, main, dessert) for one single price.
- **Hors d'œuvre** (or-derv): A "first course" or "appetizer." A small, savory dish served at the beginning of a meal.
- **Entrée** (on-tray): In classic French terms, this is the course *after* the appetizer. In modern (especially American) use, it means the *main course*.
- **Garnish**: An edible item used to decorate a dish to make it look more attractive.

3. COMPILATION OF MENU IN FRENCH (CLASSIC 10-COURSE MENU)

A classic French menu is a long, elaborate sequence of courses designed to showcase the skill of the kitchen. Modern menus are much shorter (usually 3 courses), but this is the traditional order.

1. **Hors d'œuvre** (Appetizer) - e.g., Prawn Cocktail
2. **Potage** (Soup) - e.g., *Potage Parmentier* (Potato and Leek Soup)
3. **Poisson** (Fish) - e.g., *Sole Meunière*
4. **Entrée** (Entry/First Main) - e.g., A light dish of chicken or pasta.
5. **Pièce de Résistance** (The Main Event) - e.g., *Rôti de Bœuf* (Roast Beef)
6. **Légumes** (Vegetables) - e.g., *Haricots Verts* (Green Beans)
7. **Salade** (Salad) - e.g., *Salade Verte* (Green Salad, often served *after* the main course).
8. **Fromage** (Cheese) - A selection of cheeses.
9. **Entremet / Dessert** (Dessert) - e.g., *Mousse au Chocolat*
10. **Café** (Coffee)

EVALUATION

1. What does the term *Mise en Place* mean, and why is it important?
2. What is the difference between *Julienne* and *Brunoise*?
3. Explain the difference between *Sauté* and *Braise*.

4. What is the difference between an *À la carte* and a *Table d'hôte* menu?

ASSIGNMENT

Create a simple 3-course *Table d'hôte* menu for a new French-themed restaurant. You must use the correct French menu terms for the *courses* (e.g., Potage, Plat Principal, Dessert) and invent one French-sounding *dish name* for each course.

WEEK 9: SAFETY PRECAUTIONS IN THE KITCHEN

1. MEANING OF SAFETY

Safety is the state of being protected from harm, danger, risk, or injury. **Kitchen safety** refers to the specific policies, procedures, and practices put in place to prevent accidents in a food production environment. A professional kitchen is a hazardous place, and safety is the number one priority.



2. TYPES AND CAUSES OF ACCIDENTS

Accidents are almost always caused by **human error, carelessness, or a lack of training.**

- **CUTS:**

- **Types:** Minor cuts from knives, severe cuts from equipment (slicers).
- **Causes:**
 - Using **dull knives** (they require more pressure and can slip).
 - Using the **wrong knife** for the job.
 - **Incorrect cutting technique** (not using the "claw grip" to protect fingers).
 - Not using a **stable cutting board** (placing a wet cloth underneath helps).
 - Broken glass hidden in a sink of soapy water.
 - Trying to **catch a falling knife**.

- **BURNS AND SCALDS:**

- **Types:** Dry heat burns (from hot pans, ovens) and wet heat scalds (from steam, hot oil, hot water).
- **Causes:**
 - **Spillage** of hot liquids or oil.
 - Not using a **dry cloth** to handle hot pans (a wet one conducts heat).
 - **Steam** escaping from a pot (opening the lid away from you).
 - Overfilling pans with oil (leading to a *boil-over*).
 - **Carelessness** around deep-fat fryers.

- **FALLS:**

- **Types:** Slips (on wet surfaces) and trips (on objects).
- **Causes:**
 - **Wet or greasy floors** (the most common cause).
 - Spills that are **not cleaned up immediately**.
 - **Obstacles** in walkways (boxes, bags, mops).
 - Wearing the **wrong footwear** (not non-slip).
 - Poor lighting.

- **FIRE:**

- **Types:** Grease fires, gas leaks, electrical fires.
- **Causes:**
 - **Unattended cooking** (especially fryers or grills).
 - A **build-up of grease** in filters and on cookers (which can ignite).

- **Faulty electrical wiring** or equipment.
- Flammable materials (towels, boxes) kept too close to a heat source.
- **ELECTRIC SHOCK:**
 - **Causes:**
 - Using electrical equipment with **wet hands**.
 - **Faulty or damaged plugs** and cords.
 - **Liquid spilling** into electrical equipment.

3. PREVENTION AND MANAGEMENT OF ACCIDENTS

Safety is based on **prevention**.

A. PREVENTION

1. **Personal:**
 - Wear the correct **uniform (PPE)**: Non-slip safety shoes, clean chef jacket, apron.
 - **No jewelry** (can get caught in machines or harbor bacteria).
 - Tie back or cover hair.
2. **Floors:**
 - **"Clean as you go."** Clean all spills *immediately*.
 - Use "Wet Floor" warning signs.
 - Keep walkways clear of all obstacles.
3. **Knives:**
 - Keep knives **sharp**.
 - Use the correct cutting technique (claw grip).
 - Always cut on a stable board.
 - **NEVER** try to catch a falling knife. Let it fall.
 - Wash and store knives separately (not in a soapy sink).
4. **Heat and Fire:**

- Always **use a dry cloth** to handle hot items.
- Turn pot handles **inward** (so they can't be knocked).
- Open pot lids *away* from your face to let steam escape.
- **Never** leave fryers or hot oil unattended.
- Keep fire-fighting equipment (see Week 10) accessible.

5. **Equipment:**

- **Dry hands** before touching any electrical switch or plug.
- Report any faulty or damaged equipment immediately. Do not use it.
- Be trained properly before using dangerous equipment (slicers, mixers).

B. MANAGEMENT (BASIC FIRST AID)

- **Cuts:** Apply firm pressure to the wound with a clean cloth. If serious, raise the limb.
- **Minor Burns:** Run the burn under **cool (not ice-cold) running water** for at least 10 minutes.
- **Falls:** If the person is in serious pain, **do not move them**. Call for help.
- **Fire:** See Week 10.

EVALUATION

1. What is the most common cause of accidents in the kitchen?
2. Why is a *dull* knife more dangerous than a *sharp* one?
3. What is the "Clean as you go" policy, and why is it important for preventing falls?
4. List three ways to prevent burns and scalds.

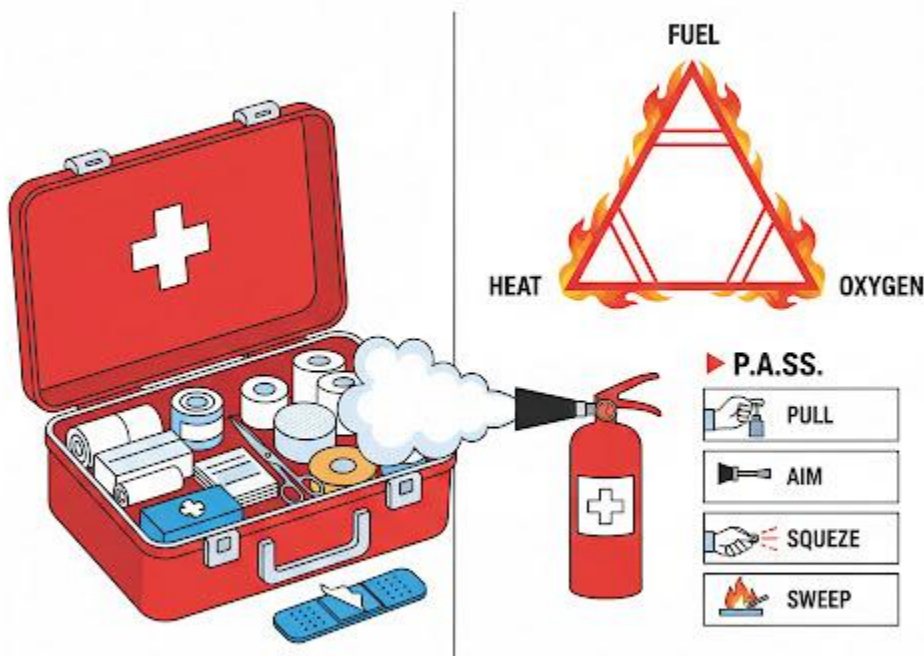
ASSIGNMENT

Imagine you are the Head Chef. A new trainee has just started. Write a 250-word "Welcome" speech that lists the **Top 5 Safety Rules** they must follow in your kitchen, and explain *why* each rule is important.

WEEK 10: FIRST AID IN CATERING

1. MEANING OF FIRST AID, FIRST AIDER, AND FIRST AID BOX

- **FIRST AID:** This is the **immediate, emergency, and temporary care** given to a person who is suddenly ill or injured. Its purpose is to **preserve life, prevent the condition from worsening, and promote recovery** until professional medical help (a doctor or ambulance) arrives.
- **FIRST AIDER:** This is a person who has been **trained and certified** in first aid techniques. In a workplace, they are the designated person(s) to take charge during a medical emergency.
- **FIRST AID BOX (OR KIT):** This is a clearly marked, easily accessible container that holds all the necessary supplies for administering first aid. It must be kept well-stocked and checked regularly.



2. CONTENTS OF A FIRST AID BOX

A standard workplace first aid box (especially in a kitchen) should contain supplies for the most common injuries (cuts, burns). It should **not** contain medications (like painkillers), as it is illegal to dispense medicine.

Essential Contents:

1. **Sterile Dressings:** Various sizes, to cover wounds.
2. **Plasters (Band-Aids):** Various sizes. In a kitchen, these are typically **blue** and waterproof. (The blue color makes them easy to spot if they fall into food).
3. **Bandages:**
 - *Triangular Bandages:* For making slings or securing dressings.
 - *Crepe (Roller) Bandages:* For applying pressure or supporting a sprain.
4. **Antiseptic Wipes:** For cleaning the skin *around* a wound (not inside it).
5. **Disposable Gloves:** To protect the first aider from infection.
6. **Adhesive Tape (Micropore):** To secure dressings.
7. **Scissors:** (Often rounded-end "Tuff-Kut" scissors).
8. **Tweezers:** For removing splinters.
9. **Safety Pins:** For securing bandages.
10. **Sterile Eye Pads:** For eye injuries.
11. **Burn Dressings (Gel-soaked):** Specialized dressings to cool and cover burns.
12. **First Aid Manual:** A simple instruction booklet.

3. FIRE CONTROL AND FIRE EQUIPMENT

Fire is a major risk in catering. Controlling it requires understanding the **Fire Triangle**. A fire needs three things to burn:

1. **FUEL** (e.g., oil, paper, wood, gas)
2. **HEAT** (e.g., a flame, a spark)
3. **OXYGEN** (in the air)

To stop a fire, you must remove one of these three things.

A. CLASSES OF FIRE

Different types of fires must be fought in different ways.

- **CLASS A:** Solid combustibles (wood, paper, cloth).
- **CLASS B:** Flammable liquids (petrol, paint, *cooking oil, grease*). **This is the main kitchen risk.**
- **CLASS C:** Flammable gases (LPG, natural gas).
- **CLASS D:** Flammable metals (rare in a kitchen).
- **CLASS E:** Electrical (faulty equipment, wiring).
- **CLASS F (OR K):** Deep-fat fryers (high-temperature cooking oils).

B. FIRE EQUIPMENT AND HOW TO USE IT

1. FIRE BLANKET:

- **Use:** For small pan fires (e.g., a frying pan) or for wrapping around a person whose clothes are on fire.
- **How:** Pull the blanket from its container. Hold it up to protect your face. **Lay (don't throw)** it over the fire, completely covering it. This **smothers** the fire (removes Oxygen). Turn off the heat and leave the blanket until it is completely cold.

2. FIRE EXTINGUISHERS:

- **Types (Must know the difference):**
 - **Water (Red):** ONLY for Class A. **NEVER use on an oil/grease fire** (it will cause an explosion).
 - **Carbon Dioxide (CO2) (Black Label):** Good for Class B and E (liquids and electrical).
Smothers the fire.
 - **Dry Powder (Blue Label):** Multi-purpose, good for A, B, and C.
 - **Wet Chemical (Yellow Label): THE BEST for kitchens.** Specifically designed for Class F (deep-fat fryers). It sprays a fine mist that cools and creates a soap-like layer, smothering the fire.
- **How to Use (P.A.S.S.):**
 - **P - PULL** the safety pin.
 - **A - AIM** the nozzle at the *base* of the fire.
 - **S - SQUEEZE** the handle.

- **S - SWEEP** the nozzle from side to side.

EVALUATION

1. What are the three main aims of First Aid?
2. Why should plasters used in a kitchen be *blue*?
3. What are the three components of the Fire Triangle?
4. A pan of hot oil catches fire. What are the two *best* pieces of equipment to use? What is the *one* thing you must *never* use?

ASSIGNMENT

Draw a table with two columns. In Column 1, list the five main classes of fire (A, B, C, E, F). In Column 2, describe (a) what is burning (the fuel) and (b) the correct type of fire extinguisher to use.

WEEK 11: SANITATION AND HYGIENE



1. MEANING OF SANITATION AND HYGIENE

These two terms are the foundation of all food safety. They are related but mean different things.

- **SANITATION:** Refers to the creation and maintenance of a **clean and healthful environment**. It is about the *facilities and equipment*.
 - *Examples:* Clean walls and floors, pest control, proper waste disposal, clean water supply, clean and sterilized equipment.
- **HYGIENE:** Refers to the practices that promote health and prevent the spread of disease, especially through **personal cleanliness**. It is about the *people*.
 - *Examples:* Hand washing, wearing a clean uniform, covering hair, not sneezing on food.

Analogy: Sanitation is cleaning the *kitchen*. Hygiene is cleaning the *chef*.

2. AIMS AND TYPES OF SANITATION

- **Aims of Sanitation:**
 - To prevent food contamination and food poisoning.
 - To control and eliminate pests (rats, cockroaches).
 - To ensure a safe, pleasant, and efficient working environment.
 - To comply with public health laws.
- **Types of Sanitation:**
 - **Food Sanitation:** Protecting food from contamination.
 - **Environmental Sanitation:** Proper disposal of waste (solid and liquid), clean water supply, and pest control.

3. MEANING AND TYPES OF HYGIENE

- **Meaning of Hygiene:** A set of practices performed for the preservation of health.
- **Types of Hygiene:**
 - **Personal Hygiene:** (See below).
 - **Food Hygiene:** The safe and clean handling, preparation, and storage of food to prevent contamination.
 - **Kitchen Hygiene:** The "clean-as-you-go" policy, and the "3-bucket system" (wash, rinse, sanitize) for cleaning equipment and surfaces.

4. FOOD CONTAMINATION AND FOOD POISONING

- **FOOD CONTAMINATION:** The presence or introduction of a harmful substance (a "hazard") into food.
- **Types of Hazards:**

1. **Biological:** These are living organisms (the biggest cause of food poisoning).
 - *Examples:* Bacteria (Salmonella, E. coli), Viruses (Hepatitis A), Moulds, Fungi.
2. **Chemical:** Harmful chemicals.
 - *Examples:* Cleaning fluids (bleach), pesticides, or metal poisoning (from a faulty tin).
3. **Physical:** Any foreign *object* in the food.
 - *Examples:* Hair, glass, a metal shaving, a blue plaster, a pest (fly).
- **CROSS-CONTAMINATION:** This is the *transfer* of harmful bacteria from one item to another (usually from raw food to cooked food).
 - *Example 1:* Cutting raw chicken on a chopping board and then using the *same board* to chop lettuce for a salad.
 - *Example 2:* Storing raw meat on the *top shelf* of a fridge, allowing its juices to drip onto a cake below.
- **FOOD POISONING:** An illness caused by eating food contaminated with biological or chemical hazards.
 - **Symptoms:** Nausea, vomiting, stomach cramps, diarrhea, fever.
 - **Causes:** Bacteria grow best in the "**Temperature Danger Zone**" (5°C to 63°C). Food poisoning is often caused by:
 1. Improper storage (leaving food in the Danger Zone).
 2. Improper cooking (not heating food to a high enough temperature to kill bacteria).
 3. Cross-contamination.
 4. Poor personal hygiene.

5. PRACTICES OF PERSONAL HYGIENE

This is the **most important** set of rules for any food handler.

1. **HAND WASHING:** The single most important rule. Wash hands thoroughly with soap and hot water:
 - Before starting work.

- After using the toilet.
 - After handling raw meat, fish, or eggs.
 - After coughing, sneezing, or touching your face.
 - After handling rubbish or cleaning.
2. **UNIFORM:** Wear a **clean uniform** (chef jacket, apron) every day.
 3. **HAIR:** Hair must be tied back and completely **covered** with a hat or hairnet. Beards should also be covered (beard net).
 4. **FINGERNAILS:** Must be kept **short and clean**. Do not wear nail polish or false nails, as they can chip off (physical hazard) and harbor bacteria.
 5. **JEWELRY:** Remove **all jewelry** (rings, watches, bracelets). They harbor bacteria and can fall into food. (A plain wedding band is sometimes allowed).
 6. **CUTS AND WOUNDS:** All cuts must be **completely covered** with a **blue, waterproof plaster** and a glove.
 7. **SICKNESS:** You **must report** any illness (especially vomiting or diarrhea) to your supervisor. Do not work with food if you are sick.
 8. **BAD HABITS:** Do not cough, sneeze, spit, or chew gum over or near food. Do not taste food with your fingers.

EVALUATION

1. In one sentence each, define "Sanitation" and "Hygiene."
2. What are the three types of food contamination (hazards)? Give one example of each.
3. Define "Cross-Contamination" and give a clear example.
4. What is the "Temperature Danger Zone"?
5. List five essential practices of personal hygiene.

ASSIGNMENT

Draw a poster for a kitchen that illustrates the 7 key steps of "How to Wash Your Hands Properly." Make it clear and easy to understand.

SS1 CATERING AND CRAFT PRACTICE LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: REVISION OF FIRST TERM WORK / PRE-RESUMPTION TEST

GENERAL RECALL OF FIRST TERM TOPICS



This week is dedicated to reinforcing the foundational knowledge from the first term. These concepts are the bedrock upon which all practical catering craft is built. A pre-resumption test will assess your understanding of this essential groundwork.

- **INTRODUCTION TO CATERING CRAFT:** We defined "catering" as the art and science of providing food and beverage services. We traced its origin from ancient inns to the birth of the

restaurant in 18th-century France. We discussed the critical role of **Georges Auguste Escoffier**, who revolutionized the professional kitchen by creating the **Kitchen Brigade system** (the hierarchy of chefs, e.g., *Chef de Cuisine*, *Saucier*, *Garde Manger*) which is still the global standard.

- **THE HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY:** We defined the Hospitality Industry as the broad sector of businesses dedicated to providing **accommodation, food, and beverage** to people away from home. We established that **catering is the largest and most vital component** of the hospitality industry—it is the "engine" that drives it.
- **CHARACTERISTICS OF THE HOSPITALITY INDUSTRY:** We identified the four unique characteristics of the hospitality *service product* that differentiate it from physical goods:
 1. **INTANGIBILITY:** The service cannot be touched, seen, or "test-driven" before purchase. Guests buy a *promise*.
 2. **INSEPARABILITY (OR SIMULTANEITY):** The product (e.g., a meal) is produced and consumed at the *exact same time* and cannot be separated from the service provider (the waiter).
 3. **PERISHABILITY:** The product cannot be stored. An empty hotel room for one night or an unsold meal represents 100% lost revenue that can *never* be recovered.
 4. **VARIABILITY (OR HETEROGENEITY):** The quality of the service can be inconsistent and *varies* depending on who provides it and when (e.g., a cheerful waiter vs. a tired waiter).
- **CATERING ESTABLISHMENTS:** We classified all catering businesses based on their primary **motive**:
 1. **COMMERCIAL (PROFIT-ORIENTED):** Their goal is to make money (e.g., restaurants, hotels, event caterers).
 2. **INSTITUTIONAL (WELFARE/SUBSIDIZED):** Their goal is service, not profit. They are funded by a larger organization (e.g., hospital canteens, school cafeterias, prison catering).
- **SAFETY, HYGIENE, AND SANITATION:** This was the most critical topic, as it deals with the legal and moral responsibility of a caterer.
 - **SAFETY:** Preventing accidents (cuts, burns, falls, fires) through safe practices, correct equipment use, and awareness.
 - **SANITATION:** Refers to the **environmental cleanliness** of the *kitchen* and equipment (e.g., pest control, waste disposal, clean surfaces) to prevent contamination.

- **HYGIENE:** Refers to the **personal cleanliness** of the *food handler* (e.g., meticulous hand washing, clean uniform, covered hair) to prevent the spread of bacteria and food poisoning.

INTRODUCTION TO FOOD COMMODITIES

Having established the "where" (the establishment) and the "how" (safety and hygiene), the second term will focus on the "**what**"—the raw ingredients themselves. A **food commodity** is any raw, unprocessed food item that is bought, sold, and transformed by the chef. This term, we will study the classification, nutritive value, selection, and preparation of the major commodities: meat, poultry, fish, eggs, dairy, fruits, vegetables, and cereals.

EVALUATION

1. Differentiate clearly between "Hygiene" and "Sanitation," giving one practical example of each.
2. Explain the characteristic of "Perishability" using a restaurant's dining room as an example.
3. Who was Georges Auguste Escoffier, and what was his single most important contribution to the professional kitchen?
4. What is the primary difference in *motive* between a commercial catering establishment and an institutional one?
5. List and briefly explain the four characteristics of the hospitality industry (Intangibility, Inseparability, etc.).

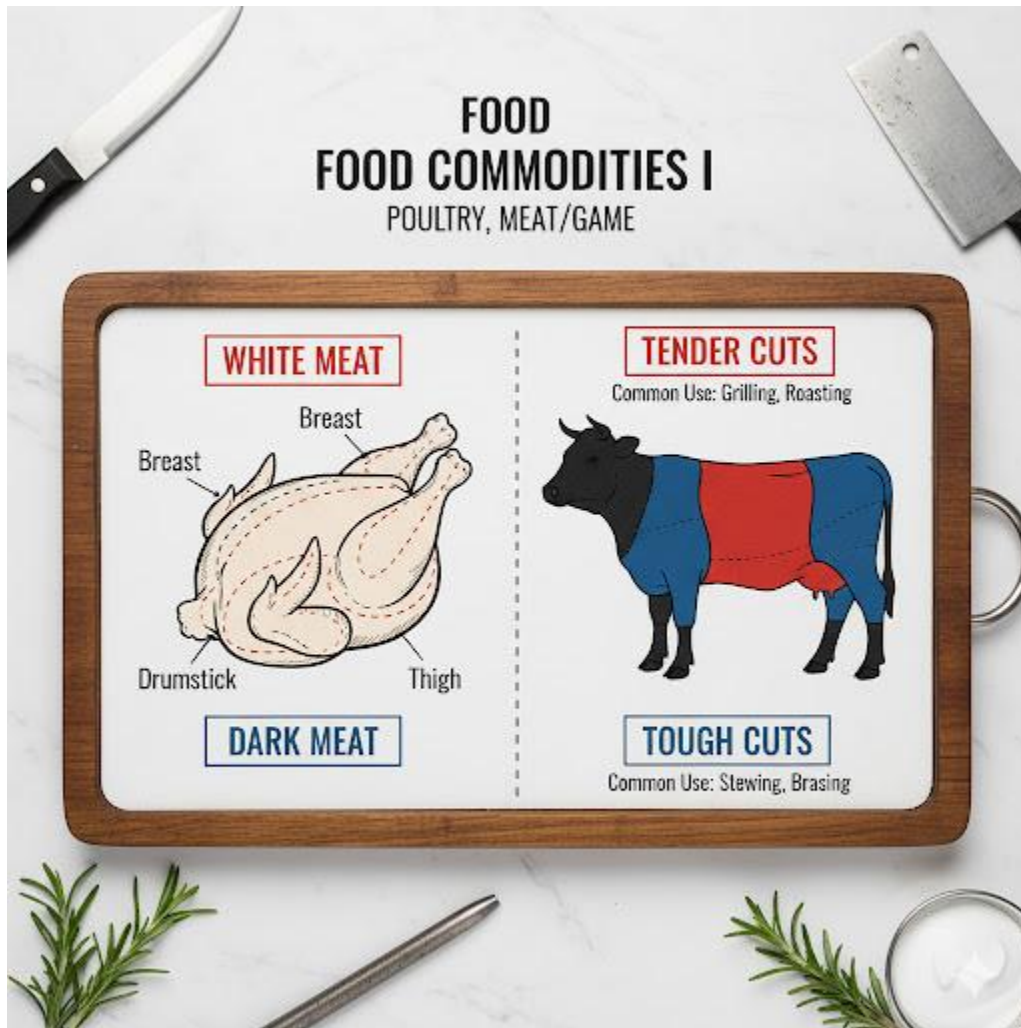
ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a 250-word essay on the topic: "Why is a First Term topic like 'Personal Hygiene' the most important foundation for the Second Term topic of 'Food Commodities'?"
2. Draw a simple diagram illustrating the Kitchen Brigade hierarchy, showing the *Chef de Cuisine* (Head Chef) at the top, the *Sous Chef* (Deputy) below, and at least four *Chefs de Partie* (Station Chefs) with their specific roles (e.g., *Saucier*, *Pâtissier*).
3. Create a poster for a new kitchen trainee that explains the dangers of **Cuts, Burns, and Falls** and gives one prevention tip for each.

4. Write a 150-word report explaining the difference between an *À la carte* menu and a *Table d'hôte* menu.
5. Define the following First Term culinary terms: *Mise en Place*, *Bain-marie*, *Consommé*, *Roux*, and *Blanch*.

WEEK 2: FOOD COMMODITIES I (POULTRY, MEAT/GAME)

POULTRY



- **DEFINITION:** Poultry refers to all domesticated birds that are raised for their meat, eggs, or feathers. In catering, this category includes:
 - **Chicken:** The most common and versatile.
 - **Turkey:** A large bird, popular for roasting.
 - **Duck:** A bird with a high-fat content and rich, dark meat.
 - **Goose:** A large, very fatty bird, also used for *foie gras*.
 - **Guinea Fowl:** More common in Africa, has a flavor similar to chicken but slightly "gamier."
 - **Quail:** A very small, delicate bird.
- **NUTRITIVE VALUE:** Poultry is a primary source of high-quality protein.

- **Protein:** Provides **High-Biological-Value (HBV) protein**, containing all essential amino acids for tissue building and repair.
- **Fat:** The fat content varies significantly.
 - **White Meat** (Breast, Wing): Very lean, low in fat.
 - **Dark Meat** (Leg, Thigh): Higher in fat, but also richer in minerals like iron and zinc.
 - Duck and goose are much higher in fat than chicken or turkey.
- **Vitamins:** A very good source of **B-group vitamins**, especially **Niacin (B3)** and **B6**, which are essential for energy metabolism.
- **Minerals:** Contains **iron, zinc, and phosphorus**.
- **PREPARATION AND USES:**
 - **Preparation:** Poultry is usually bought **eviscerated** (internal organs removed). Preparation involves:
 1. **Inspection:** Checking for and removing any remaining feathers (pinfeathers).
 2. **Washing:** Rinsing the bird inside and out. **CRITICAL:** Poultry is a high-risk carrier of **Salmonella** bacteria. After washing, the sink and all surrounding surfaces *must* be immediately cleaned and sanitized to prevent cross-contamination.
 3. **Jointing/Portioning:** The skilled process of cutting the bird into standard portions: two breasts, two wings, two thighs, and two drumsticks.
 - **Uses (Cooking Methods):** Poultry is extremely versatile.
 - **Roasting (Dry Heat):** Used for whole birds (e.g., Roast Chicken, Roast Turkey).
 - **Grilling/Barbecuing (Dry Heat):** Used for portions (e.g., grilled chicken wings, skewers).
 - **Frying (Dry Heat - Fat):** (e.g., Southern-fried chicken, chicken nuggets).
 - **Stewing/Braising (Moist Heat):** Used for tougher birds or flavorful dishes (e.g., Chicken Curry, Coq au Vin).
 - **Boiling/Poaching (Moist Heat):** Used for soups, salads, or to pre-cook chicken.

MEAT AND GAME

- **CLASSIFICATION:**

- **MEAT:** Refers to the flesh of commercially raised mammals.
- **Beef:** Meat from adult cattle (over 1 year old).
- **Veal:** Meat from young cattle (calves, typically under 1 year). It is paler, more tender, and has a more delicate flavor.
- **Lamb:** Meat from young sheep (under 1 year old).
- **Mutton:** Meat from adult sheep (over 1 year old). It has a stronger flavor and is tougher.
- **Pork:** Meat from domestic pigs.
- **GAME:** Refers to animals that are hunted for food.
- **Fur Game:** Rabbit, Hare, Venison (deer), Bushmeat (e.g., Grasscutter, Antelope).
- **Feathered Game:** Pheasant, Wild duck, Partridge.
- **NUTRITIVE VALUE:**
- **Protein:** An excellent source of **HBV protein**.
- **Fat:** The fat content (called **marbling**—the flecks of fat *within* the muscle) varies widely. Marbling adds flavor and tenderness.
- **Minerals:** The *best* source of **haem-iron** (the most easily absorbed type of iron), **zinc**, and **phosphorus**.
- **Vitamins:** The primary source of **Vitamin B12**, which is crucial for nerve function and is not found in plant foods.
- **CUTS OF MEAT (THE FUNDAMENTAL PRINCIPLE):**
- The "cut" refers to the part of the animal the meat comes from. This is the *most important factor* in deciding how to cook it.
- **TENDER CUTS:**
- **Source:** From muscles that do *little* work (e.g., the back, loin, rib). These muscles are low in connective tissue.
- **Examples:** Fillet, Sirloin, Rib-eye, Loin.
- **Characteristics:** Very tender, expensive.
- **Cooking Methods:** **DRY HEAT** (Grilling, Roasting, Frying). They cook quickly.
- **TOUGH CUTS (OR LESS-TENDER CUTS):**
- **Source:** From muscles that do *a lot* of work (e.g., shoulder, leg, neck, chest, tail). These muscles are high in a connective tissue called **collagen**.
- **Examples:** Shank, Brisket, Oxtail, Shoulder, Neck.

- **Characteristics:** Very flavorful, less expensive.
- **Cooking Methods: MOIST, SLOW HEAT** (Stewing, Braising, Pot-roasting). The long, slow cooking in liquid breaks the tough collagen down into soft, tender **gelatin**.
- **MEAT DISHES (EXAMPLES):**
 - *From Tender Cuts:* Grilled Fillet Steak, Roast Sirloin of Beef.
 - *From Tough Cuts:* Beef Stew, Oxtail Pepper Soup, Goat Meat Stew, Braised Brisket.

EVALUATION

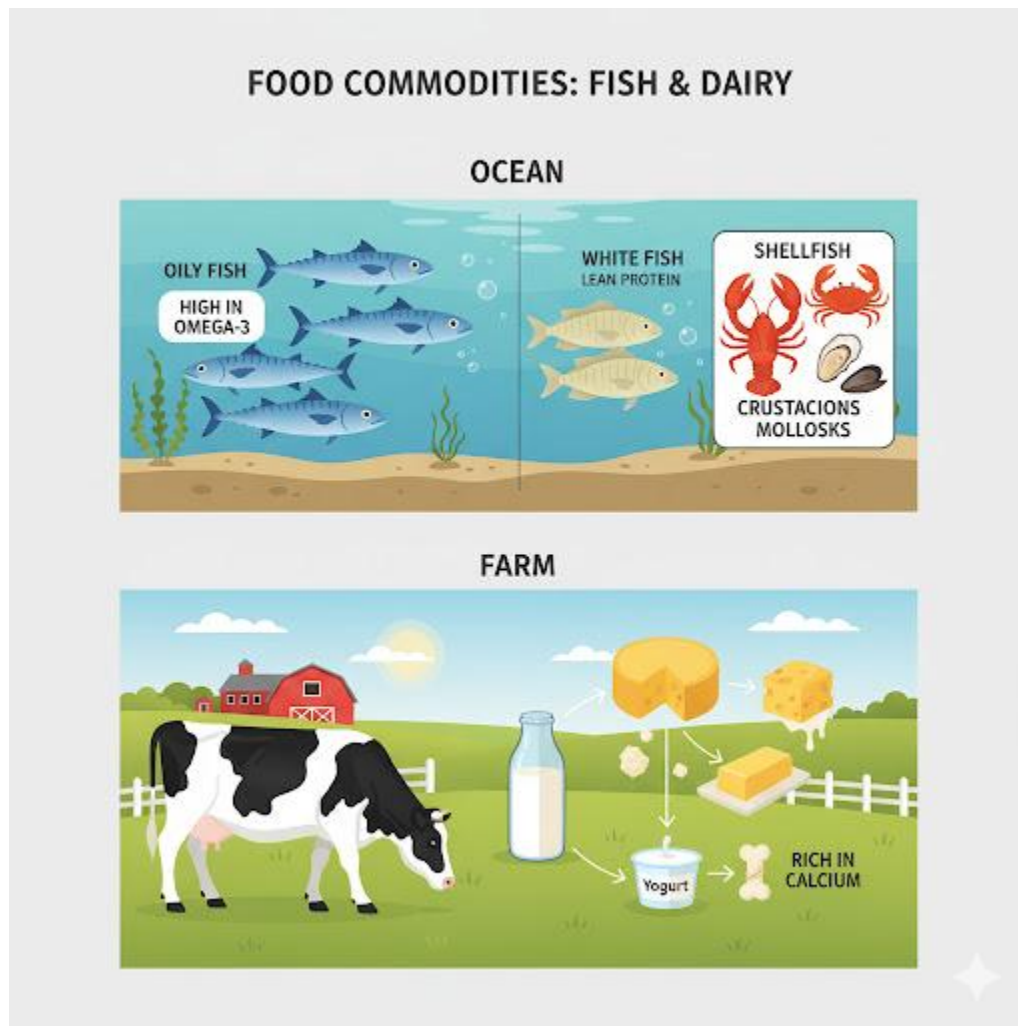
1. Define "Poultry" and list five different types of birds in this category.
2. What is the main nutritional difference between "white meat" (e.g., chicken breast) and "dark meat" (e.g., chicken thigh)?
3. Differentiate between "Meat" and "Game," giving two distinct examples of each.
4. Explain *why* a tough cut of meat (like Oxtail) must be cooked using a slow, moist method, while a tender cut (like Fillet) must be cooked quickly with dry heat. (Hint: Use the word "Collagen").
5. List two examples of tender cuts of meat and three examples of tough cuts of meat.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a diagram of a whole chicken and label the main portions a caterer would "joint" it into (Breast, Thigh, Drumstick, Wing).
2. Research and write a 200-word report on the health risks associated with **Salmonella** in poultry and list five kitchen hygiene rules to prevent cross-contamination.
3. Visit a local butcher's shop or a supermarket meat counter. Ask the butcher to show you one tender cut and one tough cut of beef. Write down their names and what the butcher suggests doing with them.
4. Create a two-column chart. In column one, list 5 different meat dishes (e.g., *Suya*, Beef Stew, Roast Lamb). In column two, identify the *most likely* cut of meat and the *cooking method* used.
5. Define the following terms: Eviscerate, Marbling, Collagen, Gelatin, Haem-iron.

WEEK 3: FOOD COMMODITIES II (FISH, DAIRY)

FISH



- **IDENTIFICATION AND CLASSIFICATION:** Fish are aquatic animals used for food. They are a major commodity, and their classification is complex.
- 1. **BY FAT CONTENT (NUTRITIONAL CLASSIFICATION):**
 - **OILY FISH:** These fish contain a high percentage of fat (and oils) distributed *throughout* their flesh.
 - *Examples:* Mackerel (Titus), Salmon, Herring (Shawa), Tuna, Sardines.
 - **WHITE FISH:** These are very lean fish. Their oils are concentrated *only* in the liver (e.g., cod liver oil), not in the flesh.
 - *Examples:* Tilapia, Cod, Catfish, Croaker, Sole, Hake.

2. BY SOURCE (HABITAT):

- **FRESHWATER FISH:** Caught in inland rivers and lakes.
- *Examples:* **Tilapia, Catfish, Carp, Nile Perch.**
- **SALTWATER FISH:** Caught in oceans and seas.
- *Examples:* **Mackerel, Cod, Tuna, Herring, Croaker, Salmon** (which lives in both).

3. BY FORM (BIOLOGICAL CLASSIFICATION):

- **FINFISH:** Fish that have an internal skeleton (backbone) and fins.
- *Examples:* All those listed above (Mackerel, Tilapia, Catfish, etc.).
- **SHELLFISH:** Fish that have an external shell.
- **CRUSTACEANS:** Have a segmented body and jointed legs (e.g., **Shrimp, Prawns, Crabs, Lobsters, Crayfish**).
- **MOLLUSKS:** Have a soft, unsegmented body, often enclosed in one or two shells (e.g., **Oysters, Mussels, Clams, Periwinkles, Snails**).

• NUTRITIVE VALUE:

- **Protein:** Provides **HBV protein** that is very easily digested, often more so than meat protein.
- **Fats (Omega-3):** Oily fish are the *best* natural source of **Omega-3 fatty acids**, which are essential for brain health and preventing heart disease.
- **Vitamins:** Oily fish are a great source of fat-soluble **Vitamins A and D**.
- **Minerals:** A key source of **Iodine** (essential for thyroid function), Selenium, and Zinc. Small fish eaten with their bones (like sardines or *Ede*) are a superb source of **Calcium**.
- **SELECTION FACTORS (IDENTIFYING FRESH FISH):** This is a critical skill for a caterer, as fish perishes very quickly.
 - **EYES:** Must be **bright, clear, and bulging** (plump). *Avoid:* Sunken, cloudy, or bloody eyes.
 - **GILLS:** Must be **bright red or pink** and clean. *Avoid:* Brown, grey, or slimy gills.
 - **FLESH:** Must be **firm, moist, and elastic**. It should *spring back* when pressed with a finger. *Avoid:* Soft, mushy, or dented flesh.
 - **SMELL:** Must smell **fresh, like the sea, river, or ocean breeze**. It should *not* have a strong, "fishy," or ammonia-like odor. A strong "fishy" smell is a sign of decay.
 - **SKIN/SCALES:** Scales should be plentiful, shiny, and stick firmly to the skin. The skin should be moist and vibrant.

DAIRY PRODUCTS

- **DEFINITION AND TYPES:** Dairy products are all foods derived from the milk of mammals, primarily cows, but also goats, sheep, and camels.
- **MILK:**
 - *Fresh Milk (Pasteurized):* Heated to kill harmful bacteria.
 - *Evaporated Milk:* Canned milk with approximately 60% of the water removed by evaporation.
 - **Condensed Milk:** Evaporated milk with a large amount of **sugar** added. It is very sweet and thick.
 - *Powdered/Dry Milk:* Dehydrated milk, with all water removed.
 - *UHT (Ultra-Heat Treated) Milk:* Milk heated to a very high temperature, making it "shelf-stable" for months before opening.
- **CREAM:** The high-fat layer that is skimmed from the top of milk. Used to add richness to sauces, desserts, and coffee.
- **BUTTER:** Made by churning cream or milk. This process separates the fat solids (butterfat) from the liquid (buttermilk).
- **CHEESE:** A method of preserving milk. It is made by adding a starter culture (bacteria) and **rennet** (an enzyme) to milk, which causes it to **curdle** (coagulate). This separates the solid **curds** (which are pressed to make cheese) from the liquid **whey**.
 - *Examples:* Hard (Cheddar), Soft (Brie, Camembert), Fresh (Wara, Cottage cheese, Mozzarella).
- **YOGURT:** Made by fermenting milk with specific live bacteria cultures (*Lactobacillus bulgaricus*).
- **NUTRITIVE VALUE:**
 - **CALCIUM:** The *primary* and most well-known nutrient in dairy, essential for building and maintaining strong bones and teeth.
 - **Protein:** High-biological-value protein.
 - **Vitamins:** Rich in **Vitamin A** (in the fat), **Vitamin D** (often added/fortified), and **Vitamin B12**.
 - **Fat:** The fat content is variable (from skimmed milk to cream and butter).
- **USES IN COOKERY:**
 - **Milk:** As a beverage, in cereals, as the base for white sauces (Béchamel) and custards, in baking.

- **Cheese:** As a snack, in sandwiches, as a topping (pizza), in sauces (Macaroni & Cheese).
- **Yogurt:** Eaten as is, in smoothies, as a tenderizing marinade for chicken.
- **Butter:** As a spread, for frying (flavor), and essential in baking for texture and flavor.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main nutritional difference between Oily Fish (e.g., Mackerel) and White Fish (e.g., Tilapia)?
2. Differentiate between a *Crustacean* and a *Mollusk*, giving two examples of each.
3. You are at the market to buy a fresh finfish. List four specific signs you will look for to ensure it is fresh.
4. What is the key difference between *Evaporated Milk* and *Condensed Milk*?
5. Briefly explain the process of cheese making, using the terms *Curdle*, *Curds*, and *Whey*.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Visit a local market or supermarket fishmonger. Identify and write down the names of:
 - Two local Oily fish.
 - Two local White fish.
 - Two types of Shellfish sold.
2. Research and write a 250-word report on the health benefits of **Omega-3 fatty acids** found in oily fish.
3. Practical Task: At home, observe a parent or guardian select a fresh fish. Write a short report on the selection points *they* used, and state whether you agree with their choice, based on what you learned.
4. Create a "Dairy Products of the World" collage. Include pictures and labels for at least 10 different dairy products (e.g., Milk, Butter, Yogurt, Wara, Cheddar, Brie, etc.).
5. Define the following terms: Pasteurization, Homogenization, Rennet, UHT, Curdle.

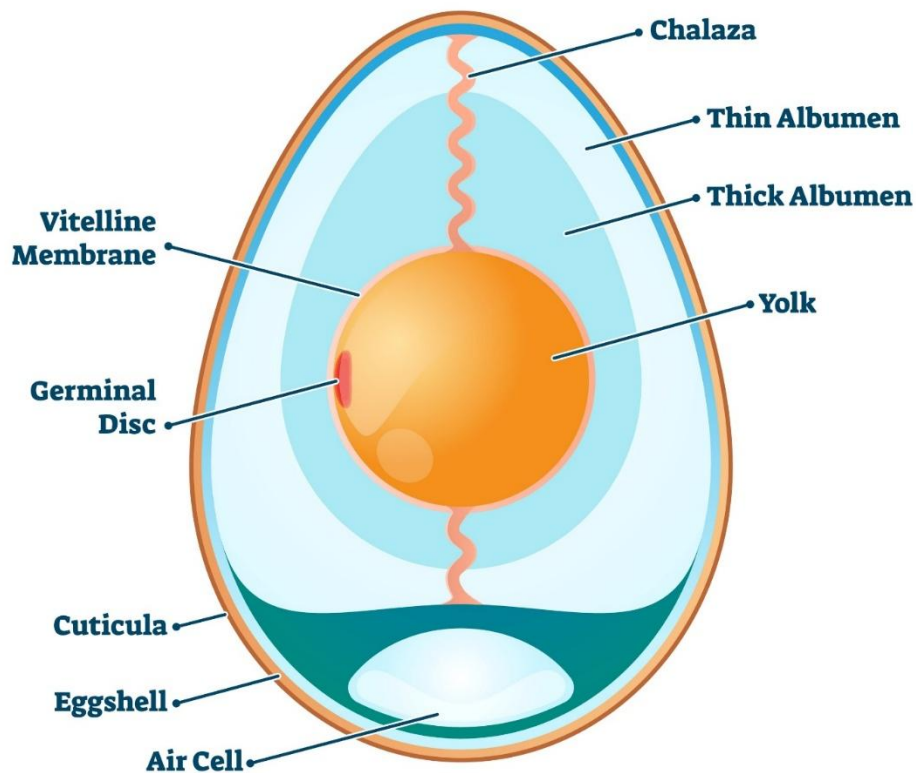
WEEK 4: FOOD COMMODITIES III (EGGS)

EGGS

Eggs (in catering, this almost always refers to chicken eggs) are one of the most versatile, nutritious, and functional food commodities in the kitchen.

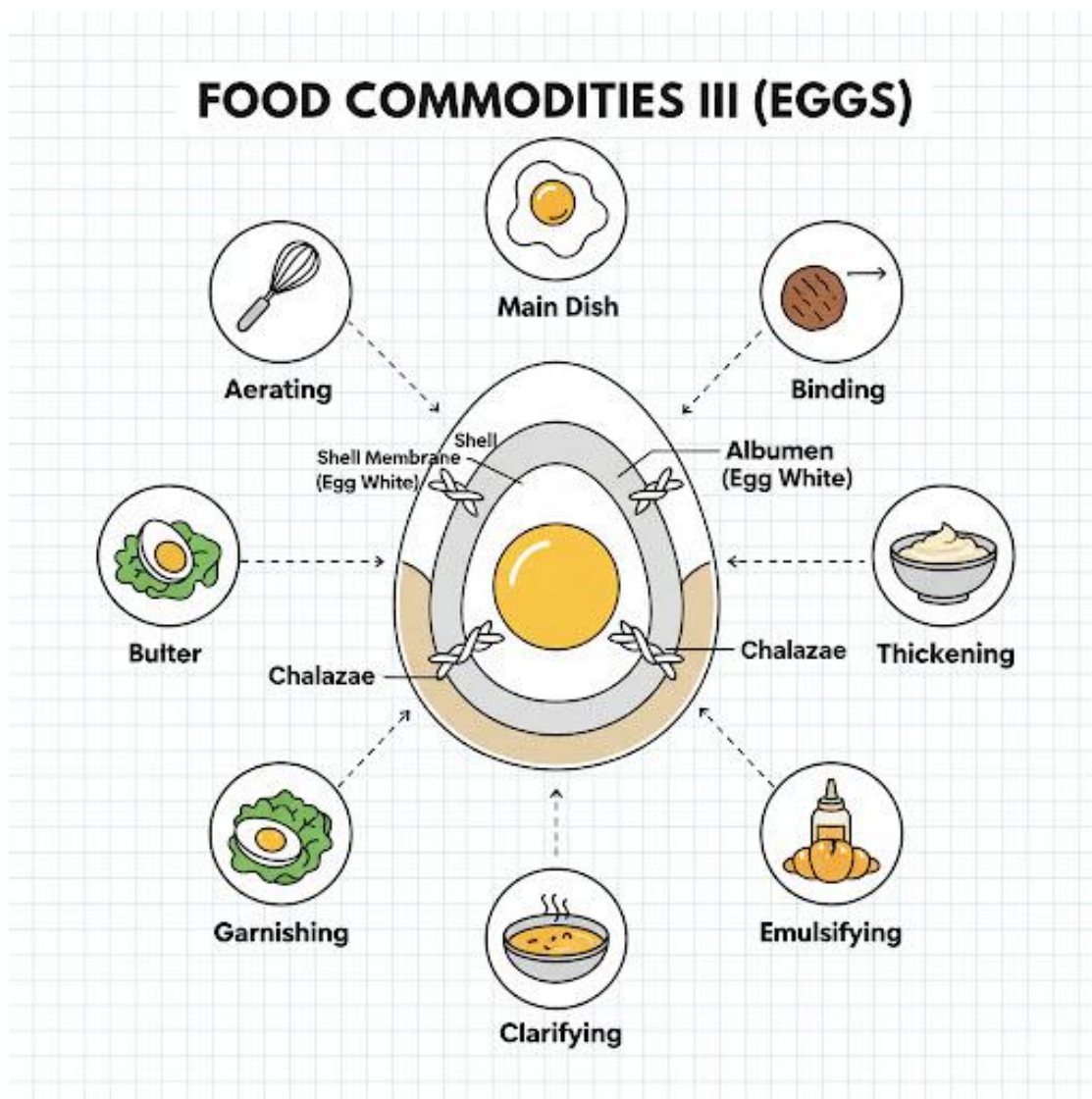
STRUCTURE

An egg is a masterpiece of natural packaging, composed of four main parts:



1. **THE SHELL:** The porous outer covering, made of calcium carbonate. It is not airtight; it is porous (has tiny holes) to allow moisture and air to pass through.

2. **SHELL MEMBRANES:** Two thin membranes (an inner and an outer) just inside the shell. They provide a strong barrier against bacteria. The **air cell** forms between these two membranes at the wide end of the egg.
3. **THE ALBUMEN (EGG WHITE):** This is the clear liquid. It consists of approximately 90% water and 10% high-quality protein (ovalbumin). It exists in two layers: a thick white that surrounds the yolk and a thinner white.
4. **THE YOLK:** The yellow center. It contains *all* the egg's fat, vitamins, and minerals, as well as a significant amount of protein. It is anchored in the center of the albumen by two twisted, spiral cords of protein called **chalazae**.



COMPOSITION AND NUTRITIVE VALUE

Eggs are often called "nature's perfect food" because they are so nutritionally dense.

- **Protein:** A "perfect" **High-Biological-Value (HBV) protein**, containing all essential amino acids. The protein is found in *both* the yolk and the white.
- **Fat:** All the fat is concentrated in the **yolk**.
- **Vitamins:** A rich source of all fat-soluble vitamins (**A, D, E, K**) and B-group vitamins (B12, Riboflavin). They are one of the few natural food sources of Vitamin D.
- **Minerals:** A good source of **Iron, Phosphorus, and Zinc** (all in the yolk).
- **Lecithin:** A natural emulsifier found in the yolk, which is critical for many cooking processes.

USES IN COOKERY (THE "CRAFT" OF EGGS)

The "craft" of catering relies on the unique chemical properties of eggs. The proteins in eggs have the ability to **coagulate** (set or become firm when heated).

1. **AERATING (LEAVENING):** When egg whites are whisked, their protein (ovalbumin) traps air, increasing in volume by up to 8 times. When this foam is heated, the air expands and the protein sets, creating a light, airy structure.
 - *Use:* To make **meringues, soufflés**, and light sponge **cakes**.
2. **BINDING:** The egg protein coagulates when heated (around 60-70°C) and acts like a "glue," holding other ingredients together.
 - *Use:* In **meatballs, burgers**, and **fish cakes**.
3. **THICKENING:** When eggs are part of a liquid mixture (like milk or cream) and heated gently, the protein coagulates and thickens the liquid.
 - *Use:* In **custards, sauces (like salad cream)**, and the filling for **quiches** or pies.
4. **EMULSIFYING:** The **lecithin** in the egg yolk is a powerful emulsifier, a substance that allows two liquids that normally repel each other (like oil and water) to mix and form a stable suspension.
 - *Use:* To make **mayonnaise** (oil + vinegar) and **hollandaise sauce** (butter + lemon juice).
5. **GLAZING:** Beaten egg (or just the yolk) brushed onto baked goods before cooking. The protein coagulates and the fats brown, giving a shiny, golden-brown finish.

- *Use:* On **pastries, sausage rolls, and bread.**
- 6. **CLARIFYING:** Whisked egg whites are added to a cloudy, cold stock. As the stock is gently heated, the egg white protein coagulates and rises to the top, trapping all the impurities. This "raft" is then skimmed off, leaving a crystal-clear *consommé*.
- 7. **GARNISHING:** Hard-boiled eggs can be sliced, chopped, or sieved to add color and decoration to salads, soups, and other dishes.
- 8. **AS A MAIN DISH:** Eggs are a complete, nutritious, and fast meal on their own (e.g., Boiled, Poached, Fried, Scrambled, Omelet).

FACTORS TO CONSIDER WHEN BUYING

- **Shell:** Check for any cracks. Do not buy cracked eggs; bacteria can enter.
- **Date:** Always check the "best before" or "expiry" date on the crate.
- **Storage:** Ensure they are stored in a cool place (preferably refrigerated) and not left in the hot sun.
- **Freshness Test:** A fresh egg will **sink** and lie on its side in a bowl of water. An old egg will **float** (because the air cell inside has grown larger).

PLANNING AND PREPARING EGG DISHES

- The most important principle in egg cookery is **gentle heat**.
- High, fierce heat makes the protein **over-coagulate**, forcing out the water and making the egg tough, dry, and rubbery (e.g., a "bouncy" scrambled egg or a tough omelet).
- Gentle, controlled heat produces a tender, delicate product (e.g., a creamy scrambled egg or a soft-boiled egg).

EVALUATION

1. Draw a simple diagram of an egg and label its four main parts: Shell, Albumen, Yolk, and Chalazae.
2. What is the main nutritional difference between the egg yolk and the egg white?

3. Define "Coagulation." At what approximate temperature does egg protein coagulate?
4. Explain the "Emulsifying" property of eggs. What specific substance in the egg is responsible for this?
5. List five distinct uses of eggs in cookery (e.g., binding, aerating) and give one food example for *each* use.

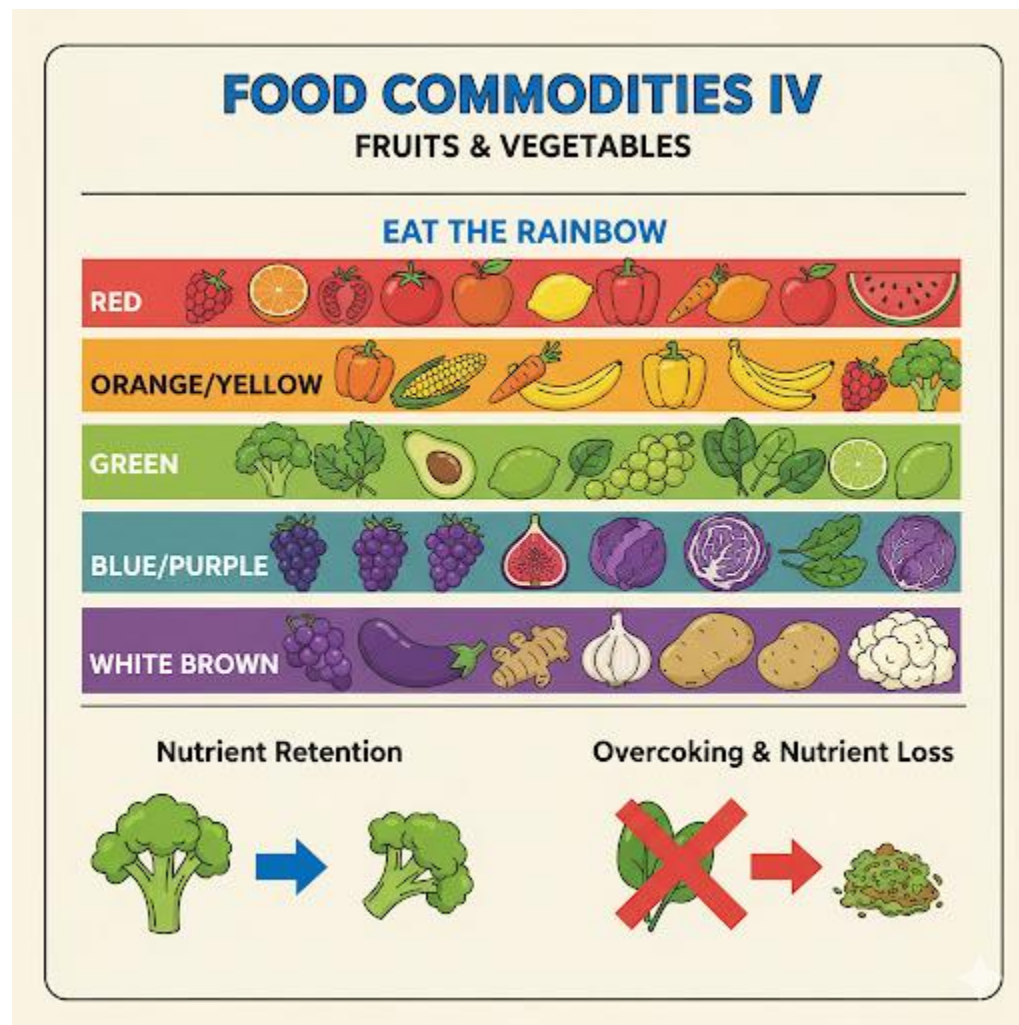
ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** At home, make mayonnaise. You will need 1 egg yolk, 1 teaspoon of vinegar or lemon juice, a pinch of salt, and 1/2 cup of oil.
 - Write down the steps you took.
 - In a short paragraph, explain *why* the oil and vinegar mixed, using the terms from this lesson.
2. **Practical:** At home, perform the egg freshness test. Take two eggs, one you know is fresh and one that is older.
 - Place them in a bowl of water and describe what happens to each.
 - Explain *why* the old egg behaves differently (mention the air cell).
3. Research and write a 150-word report on the "Clarifying" function of eggs. How are egg whites used to make a *consommé*?
4. Create a menu for a "Breakfast Café" that features eggs prepared in four different ways (e.g., Omelet, Poached, etc.).
5. Define the following terms: Albumen, Chalazae, Coagulate, Meringue, Lecithin.

WEEK 6: FOOD COMMODITIES IV (FRUITS & VEGETABLES)

FRUITS AND VEGETABLES

Fruits and vegetables are plant-based food commodities, often referred to as "protective foods" because they are the primary source of essential vitamins, minerals, and fiber.



CLASSIFICATION OF VEGETABLES

Vegetables are classified by the part of the plant that is eaten.

- **ROOTS:** These grow deep in the soil to anchor the plant and absorb nutrients.

- *Examples:* **Carrot, Cassava, Beetroot, Turnip, Parsnip.**
- **TUBERS:** These are swollen underground stems that act as food storage for the plant.
- *Examples:* **Yam, Potato, Sweet Potato, Jerusalem Artichoke.**
- **BULBS:** The layered, underground "bud" of the plant, often used for flavoring.
- *Examples:* **Onion, Garlic, Leek, Shallot.**
- **LEAVES:** The part of the plant that performs photosynthesis.
- *Examples:* **Spinach, Lettuce, Cabbage, Ugu (fluted pumpkin), Waterleaf, Kale.**
- **STEMS:** The stalk of the plant.
- *Examples:* **Celery, Asparagus, Rhubarb.**
- **FLOWERS:** The flowering bud of the plant.
- *Examples:* **Broccoli, Cauliflower.**
- **SEEDS:** Seeds that are not (yet) dried.
- *Examples:* **Peas, Sweetcorn, Green Beans.**
- **FRUITS (Used as Vegetables):** Botanically they are fruits (they contain seeds), but in catering, they are used in savory dishes, not as desserts.
- *Examples:* **Tomato, Pepper (all kinds), Cucumber, Eggplant (aubergine), Okra, Avocado, Pumpkin.**

CLASSIFICATION OF FRUITS

Fruits are the fleshy, seed-bearing part of a plant, typically eaten raw or as a dessert.

- **CITRUS:** Characterized by a thick rind and high content of citric acid.
- *Examples:* **Orange, Lemon, Lime, Grapefruit, Tangerine.**
- **BERRIES:** Small, juicy fruits, often growing in clusters.
- *Examples:* **Strawberry, Grape, Raspberry, Blueberry.**
- **DRUPES (Stone Fruits):** Have a fleshy outside and a single, hard pit or "stone" in the center.
- *Examples:* **Mango, Peach, Plum, Cherry, Apricot, Avocado.**
- **POMES:** Have a central core containing multiple small seeds.
- *Examples:* **Apple, Pear.**
- **MELONS:** Large, fleshy fruits with a thick rind and many seeds.
- *Examples:* **Watermelon, Cantaloupe (Honey-dew).**

- **TROPICAL:** Fruits that grow in warm, tropical climates.
- *Examples:* **Banana, Pineapple, Pawpaw (Papaya), Guava,** Coconut, Passionfruit.

COOKING FACTORS (EFFECTS OF HEAT ON VEGETABLES)

- **TEXTURE:** Heat softens the **cellulose** (indigestible fiber), making vegetables more tender and easier to digest. *Overcooking* turns them mushy and unappetizing.
- **COLOR:** Heat has a dramatic effect on the plant's pigments.
 - *Green (Chlorophyll):* Green vegetables (e.g., beans, spinach) turn a bright, vibrant green when blanched. If *overcooked* or cooked with *acid* (like vinegar or lemon juice), they turn an unattractive, dull **olive-brown**.
 - *Red (Anthocyanins):* Red vegetables (e.g., red cabbage) turn blue/purple in *alkaline* water but stay bright red/pink in *acidic* water.
- **NUTRIENTS (CRITICAL):**
 - **Vitamins C and B-group vitamins are water-soluble.** This means they *leach out* (are lost) into the cooking water during boiling. The longer they are boiled, the more nutrients are lost.
 - **Solution:** To preserve nutrients, it is better to use methods with less water (like **steaming, stir-frying, or roasting**) or to use the cooking water (e.g., in a stew or soup).

IMPORTANCE IN DIETS

- **VITAMINS:** They are the *primary* source of **Vitamin C** (citrus, peppers, greens) which is vital for skin health and the immune system, and **Vitamin A** (carrots, sweet potato, dark leafy greens) which is vital for eyesight.
- **MINERALS:** Provide essential minerals like **Potassium** (bananas, potatoes) and Magnesium.
- **DIETARY FIBER:** This is crucial. Fiber (cellulose) is the indigestible part of the plant that aids digestion, prevents constipation, keeps the gut healthy, and helps you feel full.
- **LOW IN FAT:** They are naturally low in fat and calories, making them key to a healthy diet.
- **ANTIOXIDANTS:** The colorful pigments in fruits and vegetables are often antioxidants, which protect the body's cells from damage.

EVALUATION

1. Classify the following vegetables by the part of the plant they come from: (a) Onion, (b) Yam, (c) Tomato, (d) Spinach, (e) Cauliflower.
2. Classify the following fruits according to their botanical type: (a) Apple, (b) Mango, (c) Orange, (d) Banana, (e) Watermelon.
3. Explain in detail what happens to (a) the nutrients and (b) the color of green beans when they are boiled for 20 minutes.
4. What is the main function of *dietary fiber* (cellulose) in the diet?
5. What are the two main vitamins we get from fruits and vegetables, and what is one function of each?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** At home, boil half a cabbage and *steam* the other half. Compare the **color, texture, taste**, and the **color of the cooking water** for both methods. Write a one-page report on your findings and conclude which method is better.
2. Create an "Eat the Rainbow" poster. Divide the poster into 5 sections by color: **Red, Orange/Yellow, Green, Blue/Purple, White/Brown**. In each section, list at least two fruits and two vegetables of that color and state one key nutrient or benefit they provide.
3. Visit a local market. Make a list of five fruits and five vegetables that are currently "in season" (plentiful and cheap).
4. Research and write a 150-word paragraph explaining the difference between a "fruit" and a "vegetable" in (a) botanical terms and (b) culinary (kitchen) terms.
5. Define the following terms: Cellulose, Chlorophyll, Water-soluble, Tuber, Drupe.

WEEK 8: FOOD COMMODITIES V (CEREALS, PULSES, SPICES, HERBS)

CEREALS AND PULSES



- **CEREALS (GRAINS):**

- **Definition:** Cereals are the edible seeds or grains of cultivated grasses. They are the world's most important **staple food**, providing the bulk of the world's energy.
- **Types/Examples:** **Rice, Wheat** (used for flour, bread, pasta), **Maize** (corn), **Millet, Sorghum** (guinea corn), **Oats, Barley**.
- **Nutritive Value:** Their primary contribution is **carbohydrates** (starch), which are the body's main source of **energy**.
- **Whole Grains vs. Refined Grains:** This is a key nutritional concept.

- *Whole Grains* (e.g., brown rice, oats, wholewheat bread) contain all three parts of the grain:
 1. The **BRAN**: The outer layer, rich in **fiber** and B-vitamins.
 2. The **GERM**: The "embryo," rich in nutrients and healthy fats.
 3. The **ENDOSPERM**: The starchy "food" for the seed (this is the white part).
- *Refined Grains* (e.g., white rice, white flour) have had the bran and germ *removed* during milling, leaving only the starchy endosperm. They have much less fiber and nutrients.
- **Storage**: This is critical. Cereals are dry but vulnerable. They must be stored in a **cool, dry, dark place in airtight containers**.
- *Moisture* leads to **mold**.
- *Air* allows infestation by **pests (e.g., weevils, moths)**.

- **PULSES (LEGUMES):**

- **Definition**: Pulses are the edible dry seeds of plants in the legume family.
- **Types/Examples**: **Beans** (all varieties, e.g., black-eyed, kidney, brown), **Lentils**, **Peas** (e.g., chickpeas, split peas), **Soybeans**.
- **Nutritive Value**: They are known as "the poor man's meat" for a reason. They are an excellent, low-fat source of:
 1. **Plant-based Protein** (essential for vegetarians).
 2. **Dietary Fiber** (both soluble and insoluble).
 3. B-Vitamins and minerals (iron).
- **Storage**: Like cereals, they must be stored in a **cool, dry, and airtight** condition to prevent mold and pest infestation.

SPICES AND HERBS

- **DEFINITIONS**: These are aromatic plant materials used in small quantities to add flavor, aroma, and color to food. They are the "paint" that a chef uses to create a masterpiece.
- **HERBS**: The fresh or dried **leaves** of a plant.

- *Examples:* Basil, Parsley, Mint, Thyme, Rosemary, Oregano, Bay leaf, **Scent leaf (Efirin), Curry leaf.**
- **SPICES:** Come from the *other* parts of the plant (non-leafy parts).
 - *Seeds:* Coriander, Cumin, Mustard seed, Nutmeg.
 - *Bark:* **Cinnamon.**
 - *Roots (Rhizomes):* **Ginger, Turmeric.**
 - *Buds (unopened flowers):* **Cloves.**
 - *Fruits (Berries):* **Peppercorns, Allspice, Chili pepper** (all forms).
 - *Stigma (part of a flower):* Saffron (the world's most expensive spice).
- **USES:**
 1. **Flavor and Aroma:** The primary use (e.g., Thyme in stew, Mint in tea, Ginger in pepper soup).
 2. **Color:** (e.g., **Turmeric** gives curry its yellow color; Paprika gives a red color).
 3. **Preservation:** Some spices (like cloves and pepper) have strong antimicrobial properties and were historically used to preserve food before refrigeration.
 4. **Garnish:** Fresh herbs (like parsley or basil) are used to make a dish look attractive.

FACTORS TO CONSIDER WHEN USING:

- **Fresh vs. Dried:** Dried herbs are more concentrated in flavor than fresh herbs (a "1-to-3" ratio is common: 1 tsp dried = 3 tsp fresh).
- **When to Add (The Timing Rule):**
 - **Dried Herbs/Spices:** Add **EARLY** in the cooking process (e.g., when frying onions, or in the first hour of a stew). Their flavors are "locked in" and need heat and time to be released.
 - **Fresh Herbs:** Add **AT THE VERY END** of cooking, or as a garnish. Heat destroys their delicate, volatile oils and fresh flavor.
- **Storage (The "No-Stove" Rule):**
 - *Fresh Herbs:* Store in the refrigerator, often with stems in a small glass of water, like flowers.
 - *Dried Herbs/Spices:* Store in **airtight containers** in a **cool, dark, and dry place** (like a pantry).
 - *Common Mistake:* Storing spices in a rack *above the hot stove* is the *worst* place. The heat, light, and steam will destroy their flavor very quickly.

EVALUATION

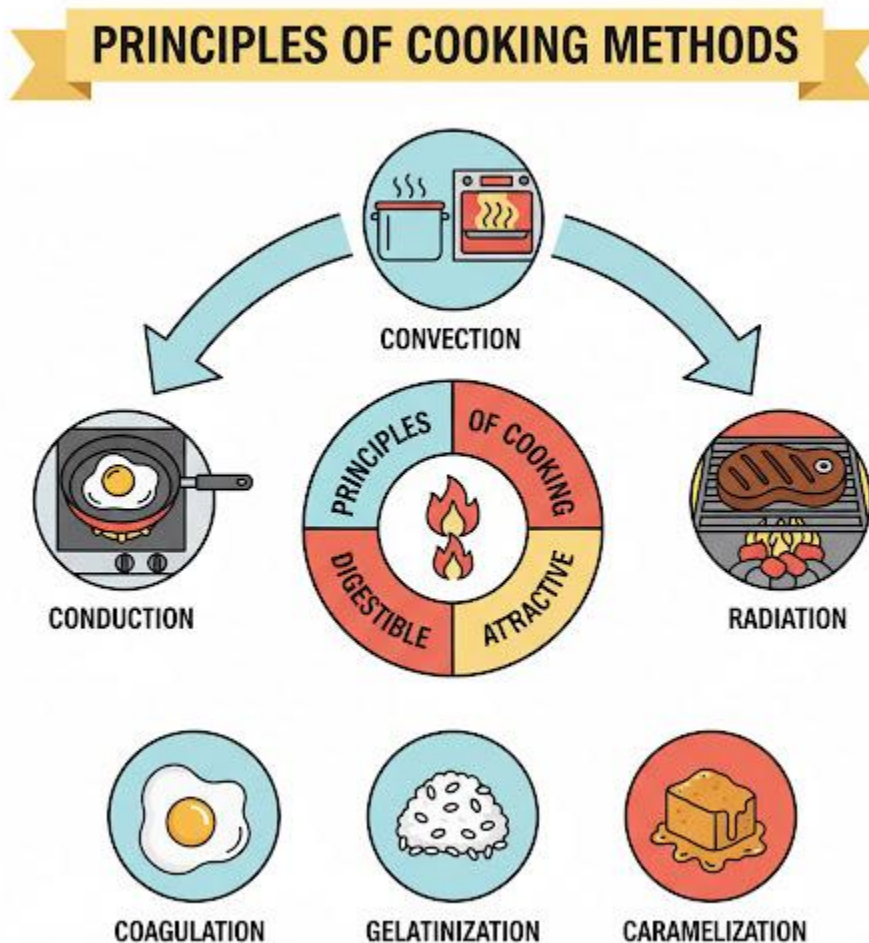
1. What is the primary nutritional difference between a *cereal* (like rice) and a *pulse* (like beans)?
2. Explain the difference between a "whole grain" and a "refined grain," using the three parts of the grain (Bran, Germ, Endosperm) in your answer.
3. What is the main difference between an *herb* and a *spice*? Give two examples of each.
4. Why is it essential to store cereals and pulses in cool, dry, airtight containers?
5. Explain the "Timing Rule" for cooking: when should you add *dried* rosemary to a stew, and when should you add *fresh* basil to a pasta sauce? Why?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Go into your home kitchen pantry or cupboard.
 - Identify and list three different *cereals* and two different *pulses* you find.
 - Identify and list five *spices* and three *herbs* (can be fresh or dry).
2. Describe how your family stores these items (e.g., in a sealed jar, in a bag in the freezer, in a spice rack). Does this match the "ideal" storage method?
3. Research and write a 150-word report on "Gluten." What is it, which common cereal contains it, and why are some people allergic to it?
4. Practical: Cook a pot of brown rice and a pot of white rice. Write a short comparison of their **cooking time, texture, taste, and the amount of water** needed.
5. Define the following terms: Staple food, Weevil, Bran, Germ, Rhizome.

WEEK 9: PRINCIPLES OF COOKING METHODS

PRINCIPLES OF COOKING (WHY WE COOK)



"Cooking" is the art and science of applying **heat** to food commodities to transform them. We do this for four fundamental reasons:

1. **TO MAKE FOOD SAFE:** Heat (at a high enough temperature) **kills** most harmful microorganisms (bacteria like Salmonella, E. coli, parasites) that can cause food poisoning.
2. **TO MAKE FOOD DIGESTIBLE:** Heat breaks down complex structures that our bodies cannot.
 - It breaks down tough **collagen** in meat into tender **gelatin**.

- It softens tough **cellulose** (fiber) in vegetables.
- It causes starch granules to swell and absorb water (**gelatinization**), making them digestible (e.g., raw rice vs. cooked rice).
- 3. **TO MAKE FOOD PALATABLE (TASTY):** Cooking fundamentally changes the flavor, texture, and aroma of food, making it more enjoyable.
 - **Flavor:** It can mellow harsh flavors (like raw onion) or create new, complex ones (like the **Maillard reaction**, which is the browning of meat).
 - **Texture:** It can turn tough meat tender, or make a liquid (like custard) thick.
- 4. **TO MAKE FOOD ATTRACTIVE (AESTHETICS):** Cooking changes the appearance and color, making food more appetizing (e.g., browning bread, searing meat).

TYPES OF HEAT TRANSFER

Cooking is only possible because heat moves from a *source* (like a fire, gas flame, or an electric element) to the *food*. This movement, or "transfer," happens in three ways:

1. CONDUCTION:

- **Definition:** Heat transfer through **direct contact**. Heat energy moves from one molecule to the next in a solid object.
- *Example 1:* The stove's hot plate touches the *bottom of a pot*. The pot gets hot.
- *Example 2:* The hot pot touches the *oil*. The oil gets hot.
- *Example 3:* The hot oil touches the *plantain*. The plantain cooks.
- *This is the primary principle behind **frying** and **sautéing**.*

2. CONVECTION:

- **Definition:** Heat transfer through the movement of a **fluid (which means a liquid or a gas)**. Hotter, lighter fluid rises, and cooler, denser fluid sinks. This creates a "convection current" that circulates the heat.
- *Example 1 (Liquid):* In a pot of **boiling** water, the hot water at the bottom rises, and the cooler water at the top sinks to be heated. This circular current is what cooks the yam.

- *Example 2 (Gas):* In an **oven**, the air is heated. This hot air circulates to **bake** the food. A "convection oven" uses a fan to force this circulation, making it faster.

3. RADIATION:

- **Definition:** Heat transfer through **energy waves** (like infrared or microwaves). The waves travel through the air and hit the food, causing the food's molecules to vibrate and create heat.
- *Example 1 (Infrared):* **Grilling** (heat waves from above), **Toasting**, or Barbecuing (heat waves from below). You feel this radiation as "heat" from a fire.
- *Example 2 (Microwave):* A **microwave oven** uses a specific type of radiation to make *water* molecules in the food vibrate, creating heat from the inside out.

EFFECTS OF HEAT ON FOOD NUTRIENTS

- **PROTEINS (Meat, Eggs, Fish): COAGULATE.** They become firm and set. If overcooked, the protein strands tighten, squeeze out all the water, and become tough, dry, and rubbery.
- **CARBOHYDRATES (Starch - Rice, Yam, Flour): GELATINIZE.** The starch grains swell, absorb water (like a sponge), and soften.
- **CARBOHYDRATES (Sugar): CAMELIZE.** When sugar is heated, it turns brown and develops a new, complex, nutty flavor (e.g., browning onions, toasting bread).
- **FATS (Oil, Butter): MELT.** If heated to a high temperature, they will begin to break down and smoke (this is the **smoke point**).
- **VITAMINS:** This is a major concern.
 - **Water-soluble vitamins (B and C)** are easily destroyed by high heat and *leached* (lost) into the cooking water.
 - **Fat-soluble vitamins (A, D, E, K)** are more stable but can be lost in fat.
- **WATER: Evaporates** (turns to steam), which can dry food out.

CLASSIFICATION OF COOKING METHODS

All cooking methods are classified based on the medium used to transfer the heat.

1. **MOIST HEAT METHODS:**

- **Medium:** Uses **water or steam**.
- *Examples:* Boiling, Poaching, Steaming, Stewing, Braising.
- *Best for:* Tough cuts of meat (stewing), vegetables, starches (boiling), delicate foods (poaching).

2. **DRY HEAT METHODS:**

- **Medium:** Uses **hot air or hot fat**.
- *Examples (Air):* Baking, Roasting, Grilling.
- *Examples (Fat):* Frying (deep, shallow, stir-frying).
- *Best for:* Tender cuts of meat, fish, baked goods (bread, cakes).

EVALUATION

1. List the four primary reasons we apply heat to food.
2. Define Conduction, Convection, and Radiation, giving one clear food example for each.
3. What happens to protein (like in an egg) when heat is applied? What is this process called?
4. What happens to starch (like in rice) when heat is applied? What is this process called?
5. Why are Vitamins B and C (found in vegetables) often lost during boiling?

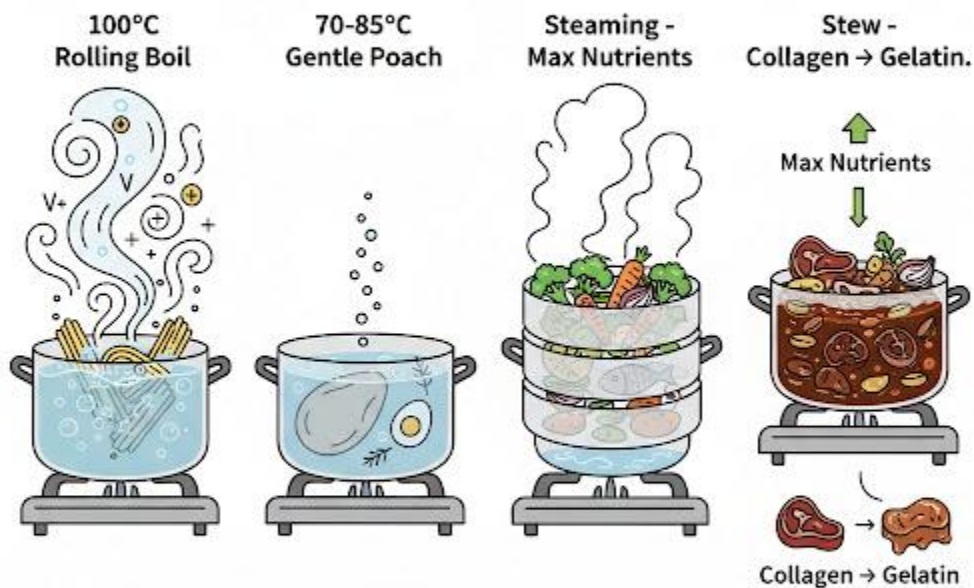
ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a 250-word essay explaining all the heat transfer processes involved in **roasting a whole chicken in an oven**. (Hint: It uses all three).
2. Research and write a 200-word report on the **Maillard Reaction**. What is it, and why is it so important for making food (like meat or bread) taste good?
3. Create a large, colorful poster titled "The Effects of Heat on Food," showing what happens to Protein, Starch, Sugar, and Vitamins.
4. Practical: Observe water boiling in a clear pot. Add a few grains of rice or tea leaves and watch their movement. Write a paragraph describing the **convection current** you see.

5. Define the following terms in one sentence each: Coagulation, Gelatinization, Caramelization, Smoke Point, Leaching.

WEEK 10: METHODS OF COOKING I (MOIST HEAT)

This week, we analyze the main **Moist Heat** methods, which all use water or steam as the cooking medium.



BOILING

- **DEFINITION:** Cooking food by fully submerging it in a liquid (usually water) that is at its boiling point (**100°C / 212°F**) and maintaining that temperature.

HEAT TRANSFER: Convection.

FOODS USED FOR: Rice, Yams, Pasta, Potatoes, Tough Meats (for stews), some Vegetables.

ADVANTAGES:

1. **Fast and Simple:** No special equipment needed.
2. **Safe:** The high temperature kills most bacteria.
3. **Good for Starches:** It is the correct method for gelatinizing starchy foods (rice, pasta) that need to absorb water.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. **HIGH NUTRIENT LOSS:** This is the *biggest* disadvantage. Water-soluble vitamins (B & C) and minerals are **leached** (washed out) from the food into the water, which is then often thrown away.
2. **Flavor Loss:** Flavor is also "washed out" into the water.
3. **Harsh Action:** The rapid bubbling can break up delicate foods (like fish or some vegetables).

POACHING

- **DEFINITION:** Cooking food very gently by submerging it in a liquid (water, stock, milk, or wine) that is held *just below* boiling point (approximately **70-85°C**). The liquid should be simmering, with only small, occasional bubbles.
- **HEAT TRANSFER:** Convection.
- **FOODS USED FOR:** Very delicate items. **Eggs** (for Eggs Benedict), **Fish** (e.g., salmon), delicate Fruits (e.g., pears).

ADVANTAGES:

1. **Very Gentle:** It cooks food without damaging its structure.
2. **Retains Moisture:** Keeps delicate foods like fish moist and tender.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. **Slow Process:** Cooking at a low temperature takes longer.
2. **Not Suitable for Tough Foods:** The temperature is not high enough to break down tough meats or starchy vegetables.

STEAMING

- **DEFINITION:** Cooking food with the heat from steam (the gas form of water at 100°C). The food is placed in a steamer or on a rack, *above* the boiling water, but not touching it.
- **HEAT TRANSFER:** Convection (the steam circulates and transfers heat).
- **FOODS USED FOR:** Vegetables (broccoli, carrots), Fish, some Puddings (e.g., Moin-Moin).

ADVANTAGES:

1. **EXCELLENT NUTRIENT RETENTION:** This is the *healthiest* method for vegetables. Because the food doesn't touch the water, water-soluble vitamins are *not* leached out.
2. **Preserves Quality:** Keeps the food's natural color, texture, and flavor.
3. **Gentle:** Does not break up the food.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. **Slower than boiling.**
2. Requires a steamer, a colander, or a way to elevate the food.
3. Does not produce a "browned" or "crispy" product.

STEWING

- **DEFINITION:** A long, slow, moist cooking method where (usually small) pieces of food are cooked in a pot with a lid, covered in liquid (stock, sauce, water) for a long time (2-4 hours).
- **HEAT TRANSFER:** Convection and Conduction.
- **FOODS USED FOR:** **Tough cuts of meat** (e.g., shoulder, shin, oxtail), poultry, and root vegetables.

ADVANTAGES:

1. **Best for Tough Meat:** The long, slow cooking at a gentle simmer is the *only* way to break down tough **collagen** into tender **gelatin**.
2. **Flavorful:** All the flavors (meat, vegetables, herbs) combine to create a rich, deep, flavorful sauce.

3. **NO NUTRIENT LOSS:** This is a key advantage. All the vitamins and minerals that leach out of the food simply become part of the surrounding liquid (the stew/sauce), which is then eaten.
4. **Economical:** It allows a chef to take cheap, tough cuts of meat and make them delicious.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. **Very Slow Process:** Requires planning.
2. Not suitable for tender foods, which would disintegrate.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main *disadvantage* of the boiling method regarding nutrition?
2. At what temperature does poaching occur, and why is it a better method than boiling for fish?
3. Why is steaming considered one of the *healthiest* cooking methods, especially for vegetables?
4. Explain in detail why stewing is the *best* method for tough cuts of meat like oxtail. (Use the words "collagen" and "gelatin").
5. What happens to the water-soluble nutrients in a stew? Why is this an advantage?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** At home, poach an egg.
 - Write down the steps you took (boil water, add a little vinegar, reduce to a simmer, create a swirl, crack egg in).
 - Describe the final texture of the egg white and yolk.
2. Create a four-column chart comparing **Boiling, Poaching, Steaming, and Stewing**. The columns should be: **Method, Temperature, Best Foods For, and Effect on Nutrients**.
3. Research and write a 150-word report on the method of "Braising." How is it similar to stewing, and how is it different? (Hint: It involves a dry-heat step first).
4. Write a 150-word essay explaining why "Stewing is a very economical method of cooking." (Hint: Think about the cost of the meat and the use of nutrients).

5. Define the following terms: Leaching, Simmering, Gelatin, Convection Current, 100°C.

WEEK 11: METHODS OF COOKING II (DRY HEAT)

This week, we analyze the main **Dry Heat** methods, which use hot air or hot fat as the cooking medium.



FRYING

- **DEFINITION:** Cooking food in hot fat or oil. The high temperature (typically 150-190°C) cooks the food quickly and creates a brown, crispy crust via the **Maillard Reaction**.
- **HEAT TRANSFER:** Conduction and Convection (the hot oil circulates).

TYPES:

1. **DEEP-FRYING:** The food is fully **submerged** in a large quantity of hot oil (e.g., Chips, Plantain (dodo), Doughnuts, Fried Chicken).
2. **SHALLOW-FRYING:** The food is cooked in a smaller amount of fat in a pan, and must be turned over (e.g., Fried Eggs, Pancakes, Burgers).
3. **STIR-FRYING:** A very fast method from Asia. Tiny pieces of food are cooked in a **Wok** with very little oil at a very high temperature, stirring constantly.

ADVANTAGES:

1. **Very Fast** cooking method.
2. Produces a highly desirable **crispy texture** and brown color.
3. Develops a rich flavor.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. **Adds significant fat and calories** to the food, making it less healthy.
2. **Dangerous:** Hot oil (190°C) is a major hazard for burns and fires.
3. If the oil temperature is not correct (too cold), the food will absorb the oil and become very **greasy**.
4. Requires constant attention.

BAKING

- **DEFINITION:** Cooking food using dry, hot air in an enclosed space (an **oven**).
- **HEAT TRANSFER:** Primarily **Convection** (the hot air circulates).
- **FOODS USED FOR:** Foods that need to "set" or "rise" from a batter or dough. **Bread, Cakes, Pastries, Meat Pies**, some Puddings.

ADVANTAGES:

1. Produces a desirable brown crust and a soft, cooked interior.
2. It is the essential method for all baked goods.
3. Can cook large items (like a whole pie) evenly.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. Requires a specialized piece of equipment (an oven).
2. The dry air can dry out foods if not managed (e.g., a dry cake).
3. Can be a slow process.

ROASTING

- **DEFINITION:** Very similar to baking (uses hot, dry air in an oven), but the term is traditionally used for "solid" foods like meat, poultry, or vegetables.
- **HEAT TRANSFER:** Convection (hot air) and Radiation (from the oven walls).
- **FOODS USED FOR: Tender cuts of meat** (e.g., whole chicken, rib of beef, leg of lamb), and vegetables (e.g., roast potatoes, carrots).

ADVANTAGES:

1. Creates a deep-brown, savory crust (Maillard reaction).
2. Roasting vegetables (like potatoes and carrots) **caramelizes** their natural sugars and makes them sweeter and more delicious.
3. Good for large, whole items.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. A slow method (can take 1-3 hours).
2. **Only suitable for tender cuts of meat;** this method will make tough cuts even tougher and drier.
3. Food can dry out if not "basted" (spooning the hot fat over the meat).

GRILLING

- **DEFINITION:** Cooking food using intense **radiant heat** (infrared waves) from *above* or *below*. The food is placed on a metal grid (grill).
- **HEAT TRANSFER:** Primarily **Radiation**.

- **FOODS USED FOR:** Thin, tender pieces of food. **Steak, Fish, Burgers,** Chicken portions, **Suya.**

ADVANTAGES:

1. **Very Fast** cooking method.
2. Gives a characteristic smoky flavor and "grill marks" (charring).
3. Considered a **healthy method**, as the fat from the food drips away.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. **Requires constant attention**, as the intense heat can burn food very quickly.
2. The intense heat can dry the food out easily.
3. **Only suitable for thin, tender foods.** You cannot grill a tough piece of meat.

EVALUATION

1. List the three main types of frying and give one food example for each.
2. What is the main health-related *disadvantage* of deep-frying?
3. What is the primary *type of heat transfer* used in (a) Baking and (b) Grilling?
4. Why is roasting *unsuitable* for a tough cut of meat, and which method should be used instead?
5. Why is grilling often considered a healthy cooking method?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** At home, make fried plantain (dodo).
 - Write down the steps you took.
 - List three important **safety precautions** you followed while working with hot oil.
2. Research and write a 150-word report on the "**smoke point**" of different oils. What is it, and why is an oil with a *high* smoke point (like groundnut oil) better for deep-frying than an oil with a *low* smoke point (like olive oil)?
3. Create a "Kitchen Safety" poster titled "Dangers of Frying" with at least 5 safety rules.

4. Write a 200-word essay comparing **Grilling** and **Roasting**. You must compare:
 - The heat source (Radiation vs. Convection).
 - The cooking speed (Fast vs. Slow).
 - The type of food suitable for each.
5. Define the following terms: Maillard Reaction, Radiant Heat, Wok, Basting, Caramelization.

SS1 CATERING AND CRAFT PRACTICE LESSON NOTES

THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: WELCOME TEST / REVISION OF LAST TERM'S WORK

RECALL OF PREVIOUS TOPICS (SECOND TERM)

This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of the "raw materials" of catering, which we covered in the second term. This foundation is essential before we move on to the *service* of these materials. A welcome test will assess your retention of these key topics.

1. FOOD COMMODITIES I & II (PROTEINS)



- **POULTRY:** We defined poultry (chicken, turkey, duck) and noted its high-biological-value protein. We differentiated between **white meat** (lean, from the breast) and **dark meat** (more fat and minerals, from the leg). Crucially, we emphasized the **Salmonella** risk and the need for strict hygiene and **cross-contamination** prevention.
- **MEAT & GAME:** We classified meat (beef, lamb, pork) and game (venison, grasscutter). The most important concept was the **cuts of meat**:
 - **Tender Cuts (e.g., Fillet, Sirloin):** From muscles that do little work. Best for **dry, fast** cooking (grilling, roasting).
 - **Tough Cuts (e.g., Oxtail, Brisket):** From muscles that work hard. High in **collagen**. Require **slow, moist** cooking (stewing, braising) to break the collagen into tender **gelatin**.
- **FISH:** We classified fish by **Fat Content** (Oily vs. White), **Habitat** (Freshwater vs. Saltwater), and **Form** (Finfish vs. Shellfish). We detailed the **selection factors for fresh fish** (bright, bulging eyes; bright red gills; firm flesh; fresh sea smell).
- **DAIRY:** We explored milk products (pasteurized, evaporated, condensed), cheese (made from **curds** and **whey**), butter, and yogurt. Their main nutrient is **calcium**.

2. FOOD COMMODITIES III (EGGS)

- We dissected the **structure of the egg** (shell, albumen, yolk, chalazae).
- We focused on the **7 Uses of Eggs in Cookery**, which are central to the caterer's craft:
 1. **Aerating** (e.g., meringues)
 2. **Binding** (e.g., meatballs)
 3. **Thickening** (e.g., custard)
 4. **Emulsifying** (due to **lecithin** in the yolk, e.g., mayonnaise)
 5. **Glazing** (e.g., pastries)
 6. **Clarifying** (e.g., consommé)
 7. **Garnishing** (e.g., salads)

3. FOOD COMMODITIES IV & V (PLANT-BASED)

- **FRUITS & VEGETABLES:** We classified them by their botanical parts (roots, tubers, leaves, bulbs, etc.) and noted their importance for **vitamins, minerals, and fiber**. We discussed how boiling leaches **water-soluble vitamins (B & C)**.
- **CEREALS & PULSES:** We defined cereals (e.g., rice, wheat) as our main **energy (carbohydrate)** source and pulses (e.g., beans, lentils) as a key **plant protein** source.
- **HERBS & SPICES:** We differentiated them: **Herbs** (leaves) vs. **Spices** (bark, root, seed, etc.). We established the rule: add **dried spices early** in cooking; add **fresh herbs at the end**.

4. PRINCIPLES AND METHODS OF COOKING

- **PRINCIPLES:** We cook to (1) Make food **safe**, (2) Make it **digestible**, (3) Make it **palatable** (tasty).
- **HEAT TRANSFER:** We defined **Conduction** (direct contact), **Convection** (movement of liquid/gas), and **Radiation** (energy waves).
- **MOIST HEAT METHODS:** Boiling, Poaching, Steaming, Stewing.
- **DRY HEAT METHODS:** Frying (Deep, Shallow, Stir-fry), Baking, Roasting, Grilling.

EVALUATION

1. What is the primary difference between a "tender cut" of meat and a "tough cut"? How does this difference affect the cooking method you must choose?
2. List and explain five of the seven functions of eggs in cookery, providing a clear food example for each function.
3. Why is steaming considered a healthier cooking method for green vegetables than boiling? (Hint: Mention specific nutrients).
4. Differentiate between Conduction, Convection, and Radiation as methods of heat transfer.
5. What are the four critical signs you must look for when selecting a fresh fish at the market?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a 300-word essay explaining the concept of "cross-contamination" as it relates to poultry (Salmonella) and how to prevent it in a professional kitchen.
2. Draw a simple diagram of an egg. Label the four main parts: Shell, Albumen (White), Yolk, and Chalazae.
3. Create a three-column table. In Column 1, list these foods: Oxtail, Fillet Steak, Egg, Yam, Brown Rice, Beans, Fresh Basil, Dried Thyme. In Column 2, list its main nutrient. In Column 3, list the best cooking method for it.
4. Research and write a 150-word report on the "Maillard Reaction" and why it is important in dry heat cookery.
5. Define the following terms from last term: Collagen, Gelatin, Lecithin, Water-Soluble, Pasteurization.

WEEK 2: FOOD AND BEVERAGE SERVICE I

INTRODUCTION: THE FOOD AND BEVERAGE DEPARTMENT

The **Food and Beverage (F&B) Department** is the "engine" of any hospitality establishment (like a hotel). It is responsible for all aspects of food and beverage, from purchasing and production (the kitchen) to service (the

FOOD AND BEVERAGE SERVICE I BRIGADE DE SALLE (RESTAURANT SERVICE STAFF HIERARCHY)



restaurant).

This department is divided into two main brigades:

1. **Brigade de Cuisine** (Kitchen Brigade): Headed by the *Chef de Cuisine* (Executive Chef). They **produce** the food.

2. **Brigade de Salle** (Restaurant Brigade): Headed by the **Restaurant Manager**. They serve the food and beverages.

This week, we focus on the **management and senior staff** of the *Brigade de Salle*.

FUNCTIONS OF THE FOOD AND BEVERAGE MANAGER

The **F&B Manager** is a senior executive, often reporting directly to the hotel's General Manager. They are responsible for the **total operation and profitability** of *all* F&B outlets in the establishment.

- **SCOPE:** In a large hotel, this includes the Main Restaurant, the Fine-Dining Restaurant, the Coffee Shop, the Hotel Bar, Room Service, and Banqueting/Events.
- **KEY FUNCTIONS:**
 1. **FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT:**
 - Prepares the annual F&B budget (forecasting sales and costs).
 - **Cost Control:** Monitors food cost, beverage cost, and labor cost to ensure profitability.
 - Sets menu prices in coordination with the Executive Chef.
 2. **STRATEGIC PLANNING:**
 - Develops new F&B concepts (e.g., "Should we open a new poolside bar?").
 - Creates marketing and promotional plans (e.g., "Happy Hour," "Sunday Brunch").
 3. **OPERATIONAL OVERSIGHT:**
 - Manages the heads of all sub-departments (Restaurant Manager, Banquet Manager, Head Chef).
 - Ensures all departments comply with safety, hygiene, and sanitation laws.
 4. **STAFF MANAGEMENT:**
 - Handles senior-level hiring, training, and development for the entire F&B division.
 5. **QUALITY CONTROL:**
 - Ensures the highest standards of food, beverage, and service are maintained across all outlets.

DUTIES OF THE RESTAURANT MANAGER (MAÎTRE D'HÔTEL)

The **Restaurant Manager** (or the traditional *Maître d'Hôtel*) is responsible for *one specific outlet* (e.g., the main dining room). They manage the "Front-of-House" operations and are the *face* of the restaurant.

- **PRE-SERVICE (BEFORE THE MEAL):**

- Conducts the **daily staff briefing (line-up)** to discuss the menu, special-of-the-day, and VIP guests.
- Manages the staff rota (schedule).
- Checks the reservation book (*Mise-en-place*).
- Inspects the dining room to ensure it is perfectly clean and all tables are set correctly.

- **DURING SERVICE:**

- **The Host:** Greets all guests warmly, confirms reservations, and escorts them to their table.
- **The Leader:** Manages the service flow, directing the Head Waiter and other staff.
- **The Problem-Solver:** This is their most important duty. They handle all guest complaints (e.g., wrong food, cold food, slow service) calmly and professionally.

- **POST-SERVICE (AFTER THE MEAL):**

- Supervises the "closing down" of the restaurant (cleaning, locking up).
- Handles the cashing up and financial reporting for the shift.
- Logs any incidents, complaints, or feedback.

RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE HEAD WAITER (CHEF DE RANG)

The **Head Waiter** (or *Chef de Rang*) is a senior waiter responsible for a specific *section* or *station* of the restaurant (usually 4-6 tables). This is a highly skilled technical role.

- **TECHNICAL EXPERT:**

- Takes the food and beverage orders from the guests. They must have *perfect* knowledge of the menu, ingredients, and wine list.
- Performs all advanced service techniques, such as **Silver Service** or **Guéridon Service** (see Week 6).

- **TEAM LEADER:**

- Directs their "partner," the **Junior Waiter** (*Commis de Rang*), who assists them by bringing food from the kitchen and clearing tables.
- **GUEST INTERACTION:**
- Ensures the guest has everything they need *during* the meal (e.g., "Is everything to your satisfaction, sir?").
- Presents the bill (check) and processes the payment.

FUNCTIONS OF THE BANQUET HALL WAITER

A **Banquet** (or "Function") is a special event (e.g., wedding, conference, awards dinner) for a large group of people. This is a very different job from a restaurant waiter.

- **KEY DIFFERENCE:** In a restaurant, guests arrive at different times and order different things. In a banquet, all guests arrive at the *same time* and are served the *same meal* (a *Table d'Hôte* menu) at the *same time*.
- **FUNCTIONS:**
- 1. **SETUP (MISE-EN-PLACE):** This is the biggest part of the job. It involves setting up hundreds of tables and chairs according to a floor plan, laying cloths, and setting hundreds of covers.
- 2. **SERVICE:**
 - Serving pre-plated food quickly and efficiently ("Plated Service").
 - Serving beverages (wine and water) to all guests.
 - Serving in a synchronized way (e.g., all 10 guests at a table are served their main course at the same moment).
- 3. **BREAKDOWN:**
 - Clearing all tables.
 - Stripping the linen.
 - Packing away all tables, chairs, and equipment.
- This job is physically demanding and requires teamwork and speed.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference in the scope of responsibility between a **Food & Beverage Manager** and a **Restaurant Manager**?
2. Describe the *Brigade de Salle*. Who is its leader, and what is its main function?
3. What is a staff "briefing" or "line-up," and who is responsible for conducting it?
4. List three key duties of a **Head Waiter** (*Chef de Rang*).
5. Explain two ways in which the job of a **Banquet Waiter** is different from that of a regular **Restaurant Waiter**.

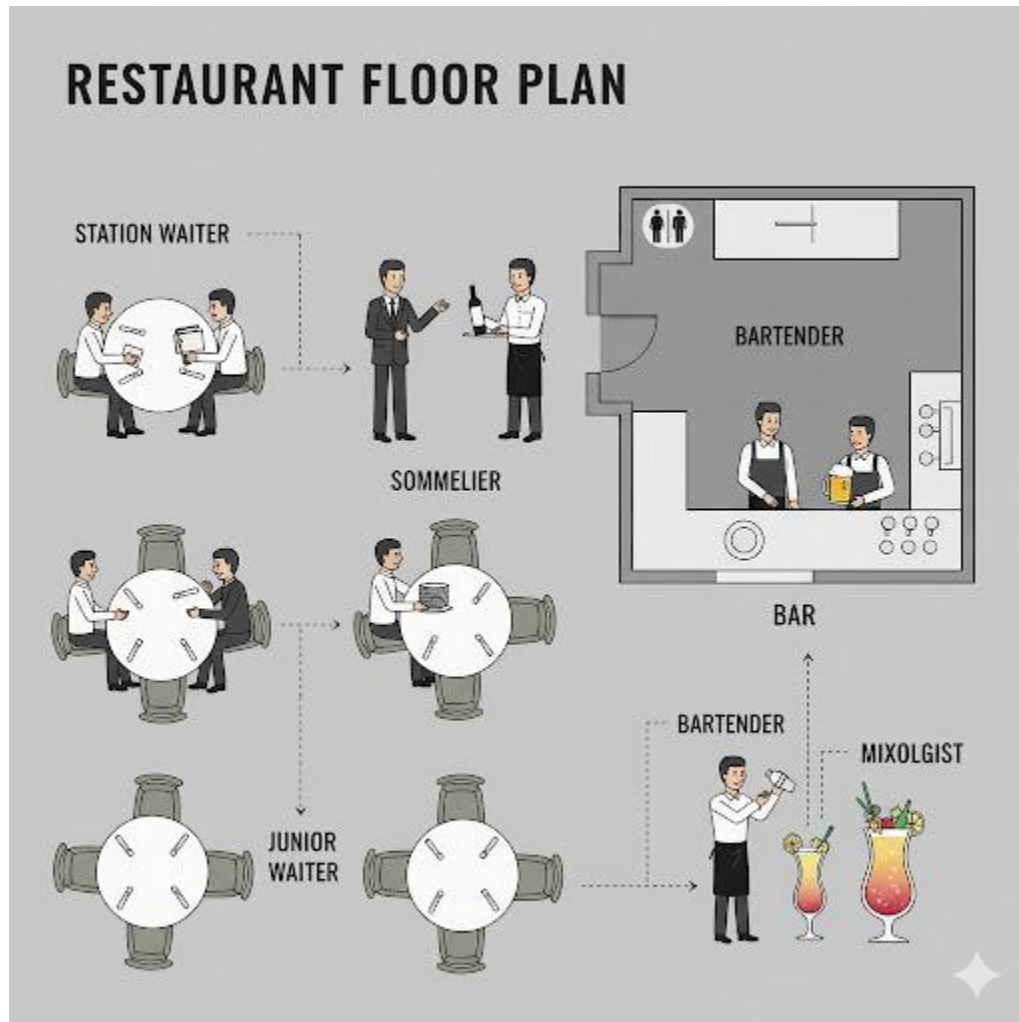
ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a simple organizational chart (hierarchy) of the *Brigade de Salle*, starting with the F&B Manager at the top and showing the Restaurant Manager, Head Waiter, and Junior Waiter below.
2. A guest in a restaurant complains to you (the Head Waiter) that their steak is overcooked and cold. Describe, step-by-step, the professional procedure for handling this complaint. (Hint: L.A.S.T. = Listen, Apologize, Solve, Thank).
3. Write a 200-word essay on the importance of "Cost Control" as a function of the F&B Manager.
4. You are the Restaurant Manager. Create a 7-point checklist you would use to inspect the dining room *before* opening for dinner service.
5. Define the following French terms: *Brigade de Salle*, *Maitre d'Hôtel*, *Chef de Rang*, *Commis de Rang*.

WEEK 3: PERSONNEL IN FOOD AND BEVERAGE AREA

INTRODUCTION

This week, we continue our study of the *Brigade de Salle* (Restaurant Brigade), focusing on the operational staff. These are the highly skilled personnel who execute the service and interact directly with the guest.



STATION WAITER (CHEF DE RANG)

This is the same role as the **Head Waiter** (covered in Week 2).

- **Role:** The "chief of the station." A highly skilled, experienced waiter in charge of a specific section (a "station") of 4-6 tables.

- **Responsibilities:**

1. **The Order:** Takes the guest's food and beverage order. Must have perfect menu knowledge.
2. **The Service:** Performs all skilled service, such as Silver Service (serving from a platter) or Guéridon Service (finishing at the table).
3. **The Bill:** Prepares and presents the guest's bill.
4. **The Leader:** Commands a team, usually a Junior Waiter (*Commis de Rang*), who assists them.

WINE STEWARD (SOMMELIER)

The **Sommelier** (pronounced *som-el-YAY*) or **Wine Steward** is a specialist role, found only in fine-dining establishments or hotels with a large wine collection.

- **Role:** The restaurant's *wine expert*.

- **Responsibilities:**

1. **Purchasing:** Responsible for buying all the wine, creating the "wine list," and managing the **wine cellar** (storage).
2. **Recommending:** Advises guests on the best wine to pair with their food choices. This requires a deep understanding of *food and wine pairing*.
3. **Service:** Performs the formal wine service:
 - Presents the bottle to the host.
 - Opens the bottle correctly (with a "waiter's friend" corkscrew).
 - Pours a small tasting amount for the host.
 - Pours the wine for the other guests and finally tops up the host's glass.

JUNIOR WAITER (COMMIS DE RANG)

The **Junior Waiter** (or *Commis* waiter) is the "apprentice" or "assistant" to the Station Waiter.

- **Role:** The "legs" of the station. This is a learning role.

- **Responsibilities:**

1. **Mise-en-place:** Does the "setup" work: folding napkins, polishing cutlery, stocking the waiter's station with linen, bread, etc.

2. The "Fetch and Carry" Role:

- Brings the food order from the kitchen to the waiter's station.
- Clears dirty plates from the table.
- Refills water glasses and the bread basket.
- **Note:** In a formal setting, the *Commis* clears the plates, but the *Chef de Rang* (Station Waiter) serves the food.

THE BAR BRIGADE (BARMAN, BARTENDER, MIXOLOGIST, BAR KEEPER)

The bar is a key part of the F&B department, with its own set of roles. While the terms are often used interchangeably, there are technical differences.

• **BARMAN / BARTENDER:**

- **Role:** The general term for a person who works behind a bar.
- **Responsibilities:**
 - Serves beverages (beers, wines, spirits, soft drinks).
 - Takes payment.
 - Maintains the cleanliness and stocking of the bar.
 - Can mix simple "highballs" (e.g., Rum and Coke).

• **MIXOLOGIST:**

- **Role:** A specialist in the art and science of **cocktail creation**.
- **Responsibilities:** This is a "chef" for drinks.
 - Creates new, original cocktail recipes.
 - Uses advanced techniques (e.g., foams, infusions).
 - Has a deep knowledge of the history and flavor profiles of all spirits.
- **Note:** A *bartender* follows a recipe. A *mixologist* invents the recipe.

• **BAR KEEPER:**

- **Role:** This term often refers to the **manager or owner** of the bar.

- **Responsibilities:** More of a management role—staff scheduling, ordering stock, handling finances.

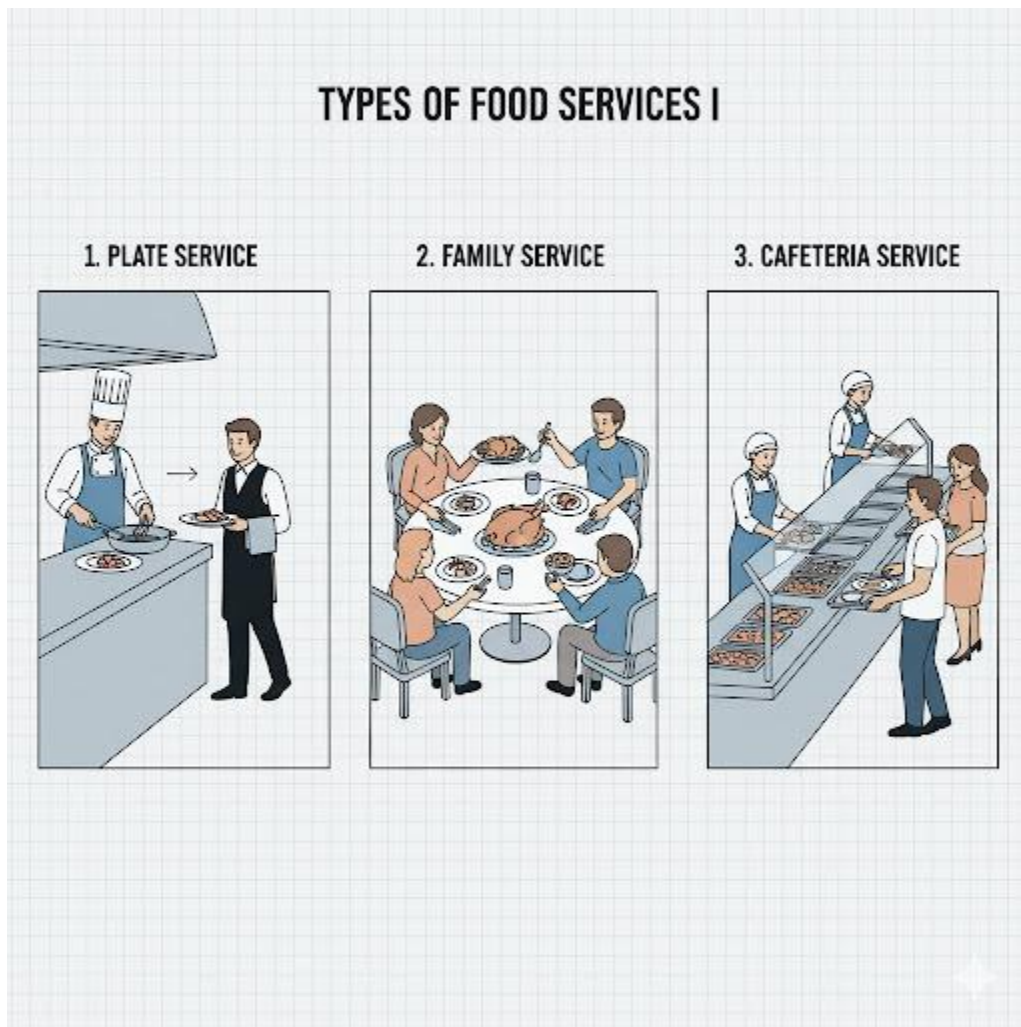
EVALUATION

1. What is the primary difference in responsibility between a **Station Waiter** (*Chef de Rang*) and a **Junior Waiter** (*Commis de Rang*)?
2. Describe the three main responsibilities of a **Sommelier** (Wine Steward).
3. Explain the difference between a **Bartender** and a **Mixologist**.
4. A guest wants to know which wine would go best with their fish. Which member of staff is best qualified to answer this?
5. What is a "station" in a restaurant context?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Imagine you are a **Junior Waiter** (*Commis de Rang*). Write a checklist of 10 "mise-en-place" (preparation) tasks you must complete *before* the restaurant opens.
2. Research the "Waiter's Friend" corkscrew. Draw a simple diagram of it and label its three main parts.
3. Write a 200-word "job description" for a Sommelier, detailing the skills and knowledge required for the position.
4. Define the following bar terms: Highball, Cocktail, Spirit, Liqueur.
5. A guest orders a bottle of red wine. Describe the 5 steps of formal wine service (from presenting the bottle to pouring for the guests).

WEEK 4: TYPES OF FOOD SERVICES I



INTRODUCTION

"Service" is the *method* by which food and beverages are presented to the guest. The style of service is a major decision for a catering establishment, as it dictates the price, staff skill, equipment, and overall atmosphere of the restaurant.

This week, we cover three common and foundational service styles.

PLATE SERVICE (AMERICAN SERVICE)

- **DEFINITION:** This is the most common style of service used in restaurants worldwide. The food is fully prepared, cooked, **plated, and garnished in the kitchen** by the *Brigade de Cuisine* (chefs).

- **PROCEDURE:**

1. The waiter takes the guest's order.
2. The chef cooks and arranges the food beautifully on the plate.
3. The waiter picks up the finished, plated food from the kitchen.
4. The waiter serves the plate *from the guest's right side* (with the right hand).

ADVANTAGES:

1. **Fast and Efficient:** Service is quick as the food is ready to serve.
2. **Good Portion Control:** The chef controls *exactly* how much food goes on each plate, minimizing waste and controlling food cost.
3. **High Consistency:** Every plate of the same dish looks identical.
4. **Low Skill Service Staff:** The waiter does not need advanced service skills (like Silver Service); they just need to be a good "runner."

DISADVANTAGES:

1. Less personal and formal than other methods.
 2. Less "showmanship" for the guest.
- **WHERE USED:** The vast majority of restaurants (casual dining, fine dining, hotels), coffee shops, and canteens.

FAMILY SERVICE (ENGLISH SERVICE)

- **DEFINITION:** A more informal and social style of service. The food is cooked in the kitchen and then placed in **large serving bowls and platters** (multi-portion dishes).
 - **PROCEDURE:**
1. The large platters and bowls are brought to the table and placed in the center.

2. Guests then **serve themselves**, passing the dishes around the table.
3. (In a *formal* English service, the host at the head of the table may carve the meat and serve it to the guests).

ADVANTAGES:

1. **Relaxed and Sociable:** Encourages guest interaction.
2. **Simple Service:** Requires minimal staff skill.
3. Guests can choose their own portion size.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. **No Portion Control:** Guests may take too much, leading to high food waste and cost.
 2. **Messy:** Can lead to spills on the table.
 3. **Food Gets Cold:** Food on platters gets cold faster than a pre-heated plate.
- **WHERE USED:** Family homes, *Bukas* (local canteens), some casual "family-style" restaurants.

CAFETERIA SERVICE

- **DEFINITION:** A form of "assisted" self-service. Guests move along a **serving counter** (a "queue") and are **served by staff** from behind the counter.
- **PROCEDURE:**
 1. The guest takes a tray and joins the queue.
 2. Guests point to the items they want (e.g., "Jollof Rice," "Chicken," "Plantain").
 3. Staff (servers) portion the food onto the guest's plate.
 4. The guest pays for the meal at a cash register at the end of the counter.
 5. The guest carries their own tray to a table.

ADVANTAGES:

1. **Very Fast:** Can serve a huge number of people quickly.
- **Good Portion Control:** The *staff* control the portions, not the guest.

- **Low Price:** Low staff cost (no waiters) allows for cheaper meals.

DISADVANTAGES:

1. **Impersonal:** Can feel "institutional" and lacks a personal touch.
 2. **Limited Menu:** Menu must consist of items that can be held in hot containers (e.g., stews, rice, pasta).
- **WHERE USED:** Institutional catering (schools, hospitals, staff canteens, university dining halls), and some fast-food outlets.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN THE METHODS

Feature	Plate Service (American)	Family Service (English)	Cafeteria Service
Who plates the food?	The Chef (in the kitchen)	The Guest (at the table)	The Server (at the counter)
Where is food served?	At the guest's table	At the guest's table	At a central counter
Portion Control?	High (by Chef)	Low (by Guest)	High (by Server)
Staff Skill?	Low (waiter is a runner)	Low	Low
Atmosphere?	Professional, efficient	Informal, social	Institutional, fast

EVALUATION

1. What is "Plate Service," and where is the food plated?
2. What is the main difference between "Family Service" and "Plate Service" regarding *who serves* the food onto the guest's plate?
3. What is the main difference between "Cafeteria Service" and "Buffet Service" (Self-service)?
4. List two advantages and two disadvantages of "Family Service."
5. Which service style gives the *best* portion control for the establishment? Why?

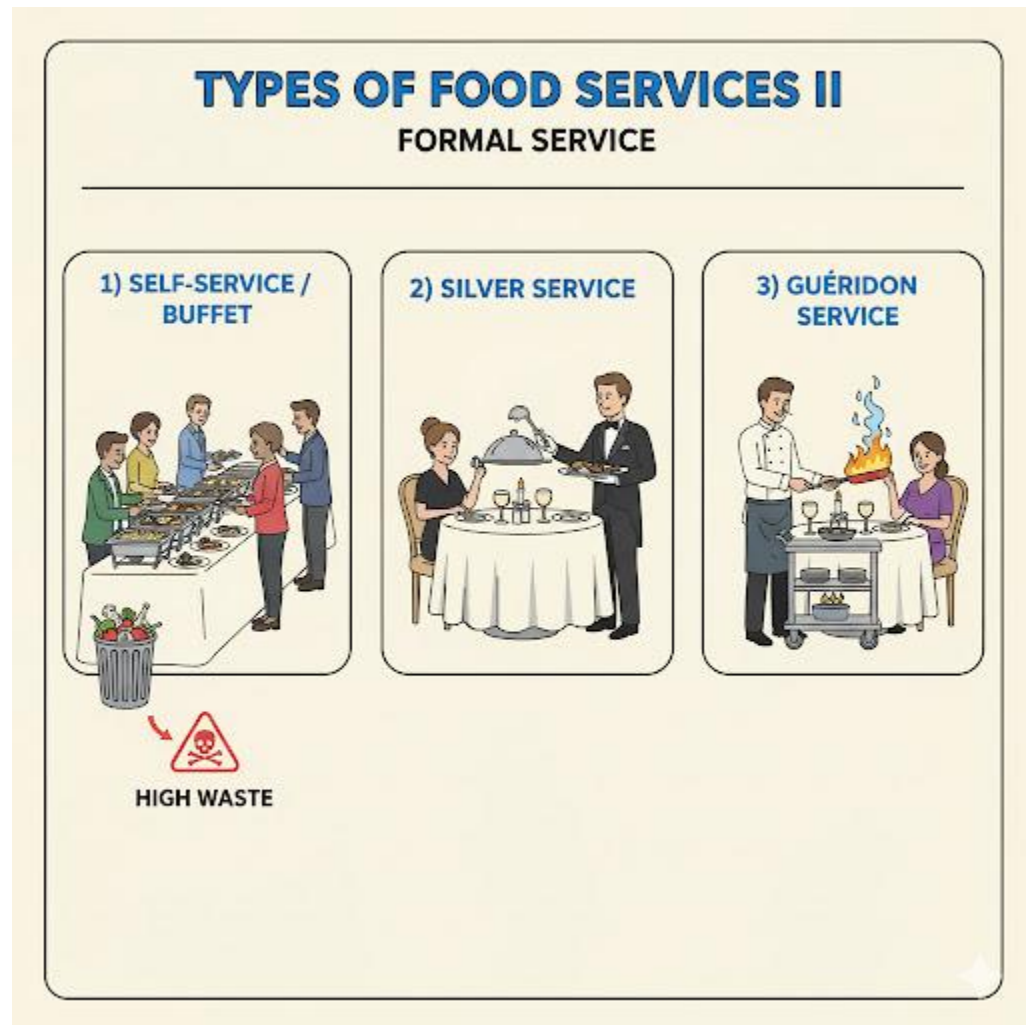
ASSIGNMENT

1. Think about the last three places you ate out (e.g., school, a restaurant, a party). Identify which service style was used for each and explain *why* you think it was chosen.
2. Write a 200-word essay comparing the "guest experience" in a restaurant using Plate Service versus one using Cafeteria Service.
3. You are opening a new university staff canteen. Which of these three service styles would you choose, and *why*? (Justify your choice with at least 3 reasons).
4. Draw a simple diagram or flowchart illustrating the guest's journey in a Cafeteria Service, from "taking a tray" to "sitting down."
5. What is the main role of the *chef* in Plate Service, and what is the main role of the *waiter*?

WEEK 6: TYPES OF FOOD SERVICES II

INTRODUCTION

This week, we explore three more distinct service styles, including the most formal and highly skilled methods used in the hospitality industry.



SELF-SERVICE (BUFFET SERVICE)

- **DEFINITION:** A service style where a large variety of food (appetizers, salads, main courses, desserts) is displayed attractively on long tables. Guests walk along the tables and **serve themselves**.

- **DISTINCTION (vs. CAFETERIA):** This is the key difference.

- In **Cafeteria** service, guests are served *by staff*.
- In **Self-service (Buffet)**, guests serve *themselves*.

- **PROCEDURE:**

1. Guests take a plate (and sometimes cutlery).
2. They move along the buffet tables, selecting the items they want.
3. They return to their table to eat.
4. Staff (waiters) are only responsible for clearing dirty plates and serving beverages.

- **ADVANTAGES:**

1. **High Guest Choice:** Guests can see all the food and choose exactly what they want.
2. **Low Staff Cost:** Requires very few skilled waiters, reducing labor costs.
3. **Efficient for Large Groups:** The best way to serve a large number of people at once.

- **DISADVANTAGES:**

1. **POOR PORTION CONTROL & HIGH WASTE:** Guests often take more than they can eat, leading to significant food waste.
2. **Hygiene Risk:** Food is exposed. There is a risk of guests contaminating the food (e.g., sneezing, using the wrong spoon).

- **WHERE USED:** Hotel breakfasts, parties, events (weddings, conferences), and "All-You-Can-Eat" restaurants.

GUÉRIDON SERVICE (FRENCH SERVICE)

- **DEFINITION:** This is the *most formal, luxurious, and expensive* style of service. Food is either partially or fully cooked and finished at the tableside, in full view of the guest.
- **EQUIPMENT:** It requires a special trolley called a **Guéridon**. This trolley has a heat source (a gas-flame burner), a cutting board, and containers for ingredients.

- **STAFF:** It requires a highly skilled, two-person team:
 1. **Chef de Rang (Station Waiter):** The *leader*. They do the talking, take the order, and perform the cooking (e.g., flambéing).
 2. **Commis de Rang (Junior Waiter):** The *assistant*. They bring the Gueridon and equipment, fetch the raw food from the kitchen, and serve the finished plates.

- **EXAMPLES OF DISHES:**

- **Flambé:** (e.g., *Crêpes Suzette*, *Steak Diane*).
- **Carving:** (e.g., a whole roast chicken or leg of lamb, carved at the table).
- **Filleting:** (e.g., a whole cooked fish, de-boned at the table).
- **Preparation:** (e.g., mixing a *Caesar Salad* from scratch).

- **ADVANTAGES:**

1. **High Showmanship:** Very entertaining and impressive for the guest.
2. **Highly Personalized Service:** The ultimate luxury experience.

- **DISADVANTAGES:**

1. **Very Slow:** It takes a long time to serve one table.
 2. **Very Expensive:** Requires highly trained staff and specialized equipment.
 3. **Space:** Requires a large dining room with wide aisles for the trolleys.
- **WHERE USED:** Only in 5-star, luxury, fine-dining restaurants.

SILVER SERVICE (PLATTER SERVICE)

- **DEFINITION:** A formal, traditional service style. Food is cooked in the kitchen, but it is *not* plated. It is attractively arranged on large, elegant platters (traditionally made of silver).

- **PROCEDURE:**

1. A clean, empty plate is placed in front of the guest *from their right side*.
2. The waiter approaches the guest *from their left side*, holding the platter of food (e.g., meat and vegetables) on their left arm.
3. The waiter skillfully uses a **service spoon and fork** (held in their right hand like tongs) to **serve the food from the platter onto the guest's plate**.

- **ADVANTAGES:**

1. **Elegant and Formal:** Makes the guest feel well-cared for.
2. **Personal Touch:** The guest can say "a little more" or "no carrots, please."
- **DISADVANTAGES:**
 1. **Requires Highly Skilled Staff:** Using the service spoon and fork correctly takes extensive training.
 2. **Slow:** Serving a table of 8 one by one takes time.
 3. **Expensive:** High labor cost.
- **WHERE USED:** Traditional fine-dining restaurants, 5-star hotels, banquets.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between "Self-service" (Buffet) and "Cafeteria Service"?
2. What is a "Guéridon," and in which service style is it used?
3. Describe "Silver Service." From which side does the waiter serve the food, and what tools do they use?
4. Why is "Self-service" (Buffet) often associated with high food waste?
5. What are the two staff members required for "Guéridon Service," and what does each one do?

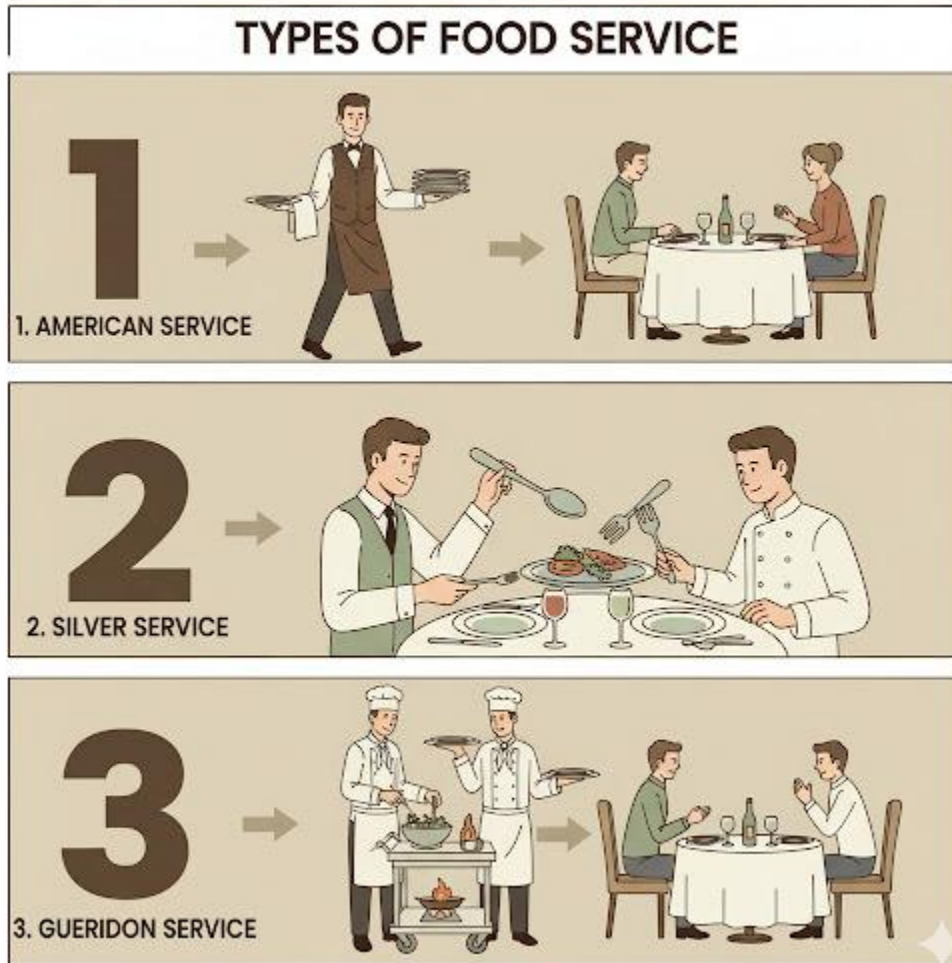
ASSIGNMENT

1. Create a "Pros and Cons" chart for all 6 types of service studied (Plate, Family, Cafeteria, Self/Buffer, Guéridon, Silver).
2. Write a 250-word essay comparing **Silver Service** and **Guéridon Service**. Focus on the equipment, staff skill, and what the guest sees.
3. You are catering a wedding for 300 guests with a fixed budget. Which service style would you recommend, and *why*? (Justify your choice with 3 reasons).
4. Research and describe the "spoon and fork" technique for Silver Service. (You can try practicing at home with two large spoons).

5. Find a video of a "Flambé" dish being prepared on a Guéridon (e.g., "Crêpes Suzette"). Write a 100-word report describing the process and the "showmanship" involved.

WEEK 8: DEMONSTRATION ON TYPES OF FOOD SERVICE

TOPIC: PRACTICAL DEMONSTRATION OF FOOD SERVICE STYLES



OBJECTIVES

This week is entirely practical. The goal is to move from *theory* to *practice*.

- To visually identify the setup and flow of each of the 6 main service styles.
- To understand the specific roles of the guest and the server in each style.
- To practice the basic motor skills of serving and clearing.
- To appreciate the differences in speed, formality, and skill required for each style.

EQUIPMENT FOR DEMONSTRATION

- Dining tables and chairs
- Tablecloths and napkins (linen)
- Crockery (dinner plates, side plates, bowls, platters, serving bowls)
- Cutlery (knives, forks, spoons, service gear)
- Glassware
- Food (can be real or "dummy" food for practice)
- Trays and waiter's cloths
- A counter (for Cafeteria)
- A buffet table (for Self-service)
- A Gueridon (trolley), or a small side table to act as one

DEMONSTRATION GUIDE

The class will be divided into groups, with students playing the roles of "guests" and "servers" for each scenario.

1. PLATE (AMERICAN) SERVICE

- **Setup:** A table is set for 4 guests with a basic cover.
- **Demonstration:**
 - "Guests" are seated.
 - "Server" takes an order.
 - "Server" goes to a "kitchen" (a side table) and picks up 4 fully pre-plated meals.
 - **Key Skill:** Server demonstrates carrying multiple plates (2 or 3 plate carry).
 - **Key Skill:** Server serves the plates *from the guest's right side*.
 - **Key Skill:** Server clears the dirty plates *from the guest's right side*.

2. FAMILY (ENGLISH) SERVICE

- **Setup:** Table is set for 4 guests.
- **Demonstration:**
 - "Server" brings large platters/bowls of food to the table.
 - "Guests" are shown passing the bowls to each other and serving themselves.
 - Observe the "social" atmosphere and the potential for mess.

3. CAFETERIA SERVICE

- **Setup:** A long table acts as a "counter." "Servers" stand behind it with large bowls of food. "Guests" line up with trays.
- **Demonstration:**
 - "Guest" moves along the line, tray in hand.
 - "Guest" points ("I'll have the rice and chicken").
 - "Server" portions the food onto the guest's plate.
 - Observe the speed, efficiency, and portion control.

4. SELF-SERVICE (BUFFET)

- **Setup:** A table is set up with food on platters, with the correct *service gear* (spoons, tongs) in each dish. Plates are stacked at the start.
- **Demonstration:**
 - "Guests" walk along the table and **serve themselves**.
 - Observe the flow, the choices, and the potential for waste (a guest taking too much).
 - Observe the hygiene (e.g., a guest using their hands - a *bad* practice).

5. SILVER SERVICE

- **Setup:** A formal table. Empty plates are placed before the "guests."
- **Demonstration:**
 - "Server" places a clean, empty plate *from the guest's right*.
 - "Server" brings a platter of food (e.g., sliced bread and chicken pieces) on their left arm.

- "Server" approaches the guest *from their left side*.
- **Key Skill:** "Server" demonstrates using the service spoon and fork *in one hand* to pick up and place the food onto the guest's plate.
- *This will be practiced by all students.*

6. GUÉRIDON (FRENCH) SERVICE

- **Setup:** A table with guests. A side trolley (Gueridon) is brought next to the table.
- **Demonstration:**
 - A simple "finishing" task will be shown.
 - *Example:* A "Caesar Salad." The *Chef de Rang* (teacher/demonstrator) will mix the lettuce, dressing, and croutons in a bowl on the trolley, in front of the guests.
 - The *Commis* (student) will hand the *Chef de Rang* the ingredients.
 - The *Chef de Rang* plates the finished salad and the *Commis* serves it.
 - This demonstrates the "showmanship" and teamwork.

EVALUATION

1. What is the correct side to serve a plated meal (Plate Service)?
2. What is the correct side to clear a dirty plate?
3. What is the main difference you observed between how a guest gets their food in Cafeteria Service versus Self-Service (Buffet)?
4. What two utensils are used *together* to perform Silver Service?
5. Which service style did you find the most "formal" or "impressive," and why?

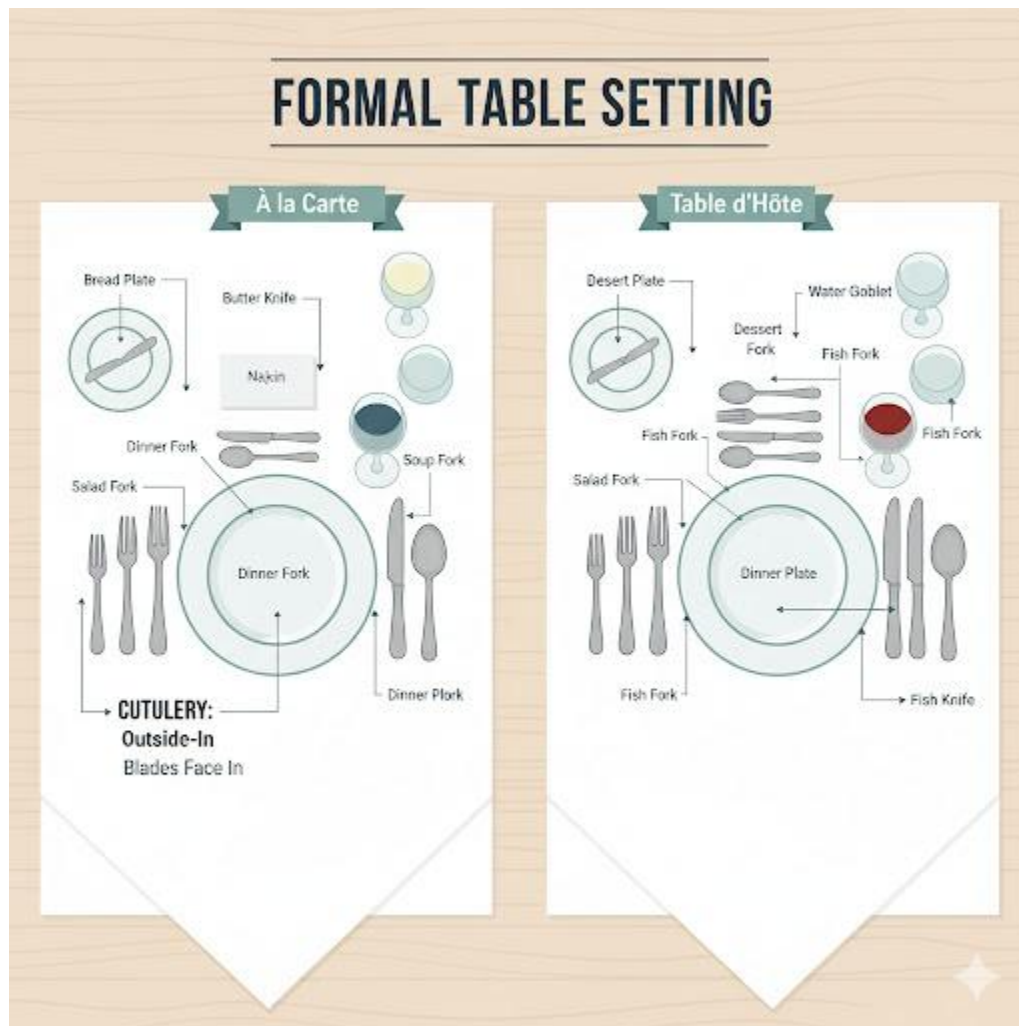
ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a 300-word "reflection" on the practical class. What was the most difficult skill to *perform* (e.g., carrying plates, Silver Service)? What did you learn from *watching* the Gueridon demonstration?

2. Practice the "Silver Service" technique at home using two large spoons and some pieces of bread or cut yam. Write a short paragraph describing the challenges you faced.
3. Practice the "two-plate carry" and the "three-plate carry" (using your forearm) with plates at home.
4. Draw a diagram showing the "flow" of a guest in a Buffet line, from picking up the plate to returning to their seat.
5. Research and list 3 "classic" dishes (other than Caesar Salad) that are traditionally prepared or finished on a Gueridon.

WEEK 9: TABLE COVER

MEANING OF COVER



In catering, a **"cover"** (from the French *couvert*) has two meanings:

1. **A Customer:** "We served 80 covers tonight" means "We served 80 customers."
2. **A Place Setting:** This is the more common use. A "cover" is the **complete set of tableware (crockery, cutlery, glassware, linen)** required for one guest for one specific meal. It is the "space" on the table allocated to that guest.

IDENTIFICATION OF TABLE WARES

Before laying a cover, you must know your tools.

- **CROCKERY (China):** Plates and bowls.
 - *Dinner Plate:* The large main plate.
 - *Side Plate:* Small plate for bread.
 - *Soup Bowl:* For soup.
 - *Service Plate (or Charger):* A large, decorative plate that the soup bowl or appetizer plate is placed on.
- **CUTLERY (Flatware/Silverware):** Knives, forks, spoons.
 - *Main (Dinner) Knife & Fork*
 - *Fish Knife & Fork*
 - *Soup Spoon* (round bowl)
 - *Dessert Spoon & Fork*
 - *Side Knife* (for butter)
- **GLASSWARE:**
 - *Water Goblet*
 - *Wine Glasses* (Red and White)
- **LINEN:**
 - *Tablecloth*
 - *Napkin (Serviette)*

LAYING THE TABLE (GENERAL RULES)

1. **The Center:** The cover is set on either side of a central point (where the plate will go).
2. **The 1-Inch Rule:** All cutlery and the plate should be set **one inch** from the edge of the table.
3. **FORKS go on the LEFT.**
4. **KNIVES and SPOONS go on the RIGHT.** (The *only* exception is a small oyster fork).
5. **Blade In:** The cutting edge of all knives must face **inward** (towards the plate).
6. **"Outside-In":** Cutlery is placed in the order it will be used. The guest works from the **outside in**.
The cutlery for the first course (e.g., soup) is placed on the *outermost* edge.
7. **Glassware:** Glasses are placed at the **top right** of the cover, above the knives.
8. **Side Plate:** The side plate and side knife are placed at the **top left** of the cover.
9. **Napkin:** The napkin is placed either in the center of the cover (on the plate) or on the side plate.

TYPES OF COVER

The type of cover you set depends entirely on the **type of menu** being served.

1. À LA CARTE COVER (BASIC COVER)

- **MENU:** *À la Carte* (guests choose any item from the menu; see Week 4, 3rd Term).
- **LOGIC:** Because the waiter does *not* know what the guest will order (soup? fish? steak?), they only set the *basic* tools.
- **THE COVER:**
 - **Center:** Napkin.
 - **Left:** Main (Dinner) Fork.
 - **Right:** Main (Dinner) Knife.
 - **Top Left:** Side Plate and Side Knife.
 - **Top Right:** Water Goblet.
- **PROCEDURE:** When the guest orders, the waiter must *bring the correct additional cutlery* (e.g., a soup spoon or a fish knife) and add it to the cover *before* the food arrives.

2. TABLE D'HÔTE COVER (SET COVER)

- **MENU:** *Table d'Hôte* (a set menu with limited choices, e.g., "Soup, then Fish, then Dessert").
- **LOGIC:** Because the waiter *knows* exactly what courses are being served, they can **set all the cutlery in advance**.
- **THE COVER (Example: for Soup, then Fish, then Dessert):**
 - **Center:** Service Plate (or just space).
 - **Left (Inside-Out):** Fish Fork, Main Fork (if needed). *Wait, this example is Soup, Fish, Dessert. So:*
 - **Left (Inside-Out): Fish Fork.**
 - **Right (Inside-Out): Fish Knife, then Soup Spoon** (on the outermost right).
 - **Top: Dessert Spoon and Dessert Fork** (placed horizontally, spoon handle to the right, fork handle to the left).
 - **Top Left:** Side Plate and Side Knife.
 - **Top Right:** Water Goblet (and Wine Glass, if needed).

EVALUATION

1. What are the two meanings of the word "Cover" in catering?
2. List the 4 main categories of "Table Wares."
3. What is the "Outside-In" rule for cutlery placement?
4. What is the main difference between laying an *À la Carte* cover and a *Table d'Hôte* cover?
5. Where are the following items placed in a standard cover: (a) Water Glass, (b) Side Plate, (c) Soup Spoon?

ASSIGNMENT

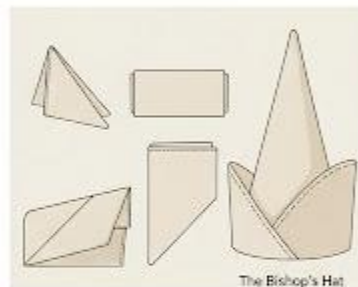
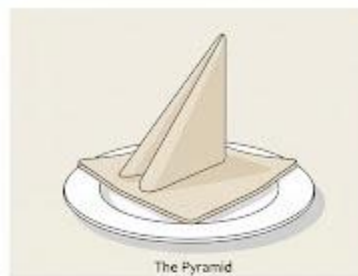
1. **Practical:** At home, lay a complete *Table d'Hôte* cover for a 3-course meal consisting of: **Appetizer (Fork only), Main Course (Knife and Fork), and Dessert (Spoon only).**
2. Draw a diagram of the cover you set and label every single item (all 6 pieces of cutlery, plate, side plate, glass).
3. Write a 150-word report on the "dos and don'ts" of handling cutlery. (e.g., "Do hold by the handle," "Don't touch the tines of the fork").
4. Research and list 5 different types of glassware and what they are used for (e.g., Highball, Flute, Snifter).
5. Define the following: Crockery, Cutlery, Charger/Service Plate, *À la Carte*, *Table d'Hôte*.

WEEK 10: NAPKIN FOLDING

MEANING OF NAPKIN FOLDING

A **Napkin** (or *Serviette*) is a square of linen or paper used by a guest to wipe their mouth and protect their clothing.

Napkin Folding is the *art and craft* of folding a napkin into a decorative shape. It is a key part of table presentation and *mise-en-place*.



- **PURPOSE:**

1. **Aesthetics:** A well-folded napkin enhances the beauty and "wow-factor" of the table setting.
2. **Hygiene:** It presents the napkin to the guest in a way that is clean and has been handled minimally.

3. **Function:** Some folds (like the "Pocket") are designed to hold cutlery.

TYPES OF NAPKINS

- **LINEN NAPKINS:**

- Made from fabric (cotton, linen, damask).
- Used in fine-dining, hotels, and formal events.
- Must be **starched** to hold their shape for complex folds.

- **PAPER NAPKINS:**

- Used in casual dining, fast food, cafeterias, and bars.
- They are disposable.
- Can only be folded into very simple shapes (e.g., "Triangle," "Rectangle").

STYLES AND METHODS OF FOLDING NAPKINS

The style of fold depends on the napkin type (starched or soft) and where it will be placed (on the plate, in a glass).

1. SIMPLE FOLDS (FOR PAPER OR SOFT LINEN)

- **Triangle:** Fold the square in half diagonally. Place on the side plate.
- **Rectangle (Book Fold):** Fold in half, then in half again. Place on the side plate or under the forks.
- **Basic Pocket:** A simple fold that creates a pocket for holding cutlery. Used in casual restaurants.

2. UPRIGHT FOLDS (FOR STARCHED LINEN - TO STAND ON A PLATE)

- **THE PYRAMID (OR TENT FOLD):**

1. Fold the napkin in half diagonally to make a triangle.
2. Fold the two far corners up to meet the top point, making a square.
3. Turn the square over.
4. Fold it in half to make a triangle.

5. Pick it up and stand it on its base. It forms a stable pyramid.

- **THE BISHOP'S HAT (OR MITRE):**

1. This is a more complex, classic fold.
2. Fold the napkin in half horizontally.
3. Fold the top right and bottom left corners to the center.
4. Fold the other two corners to the center to form a diamond.
5. Fold the bottom point up to the top point.
6. Pull the "wings" out from the side and tuck one into the other to form a "hat."

3. FANCY FOLDS (FOR PLATES OR GLASSES)

- **THE FAN:**

1. Fold the napkin in half.
2. "Accordion" or "pleat" the napkin from one end, leaving the last 4 inches flat.
3. Fold the entire unit in half (pleats on the outside).
4. Fold the flat, un-pleated corner diagonally and tuck it in to form a "stand."
5. Release the pleats to open the fan.
6. *Variation:* The fan can also be placed in a water goblet.

- **THE BIRD OF PARADISE:**

1. Fold the napkin in half, and then in half again to make a small square.
2. Fold the "open" corners diagonally up to the "closed" corner, one by one.
3. Fold the two side corners underneath.
4. Pull up the four "petals" or "feathers" to create the "bird."

EVALUATION

1. What are the three main purposes of napkin folding?
2. What is the main difference between a linen napkin and a paper napkin?
3. Why must linen napkins be **starched** for folding?
4. Name two "upright" folds and one "fancy" fold.
5. Where can a "Fan" fold be placed on a cover?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Get a square piece of cloth or a paper napkin. Attempt to fold:
 - The Pyramid
 - The Fan (to stand on a plate)
2. Take photos of your 2 successful folds.
3. Research and write down the step-by-step instructions for one *new* fold not listed in these notes (e.g., "The Rose," "The Sail").
4. Write a 150-word report on the "Hygiene" aspect of napkin folding. (e.g., Why is it important to wash hands before folding? Why is a complex fold with too much handling sometimes *less* hygienic?).
5. What are the "pros and cons" of using paper napkins versus linen napkins from the perspective of a restaurant owner?

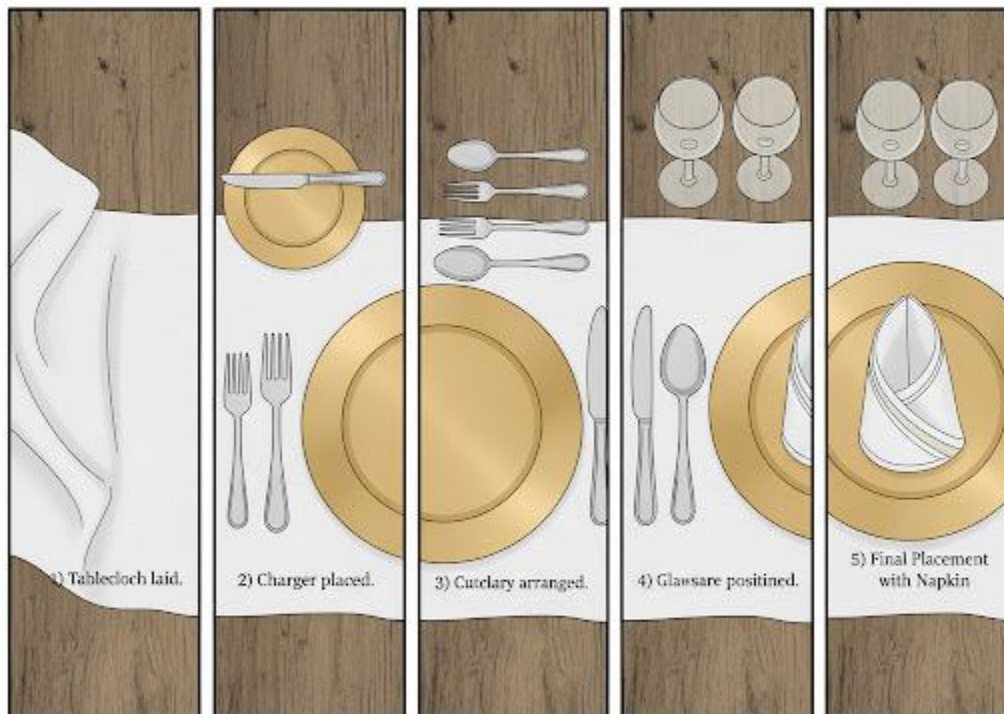
WEEK 11: DEMONSTRATION OF NAPKIN FOLDS AND PLACEMENT OF TABLE WARES

TOPIC: PRACTICAL: LAYING A FULL TABLE D'HÔTE COVER

OBJECTIVES

This week is a practical session that **combines** the knowledge from Week 9 (Table Cover) and Week 10 (Napkin Folding).

DEMONSTATION OF NAPKIN FOLDS AND PLACEMENT OF TABLE WARES



- To demonstrate the correct, professional sequence for laying a table.
- To practice and perfect at least three different napkin folds.

- To correctly place all required table wares (crockery, cutlery, glassware, linen) for a formal 3-course meal.
- To develop an "eye" for detail, precision, and symmetry in table setting.

EQUIPMENT FOR DEMONSTRATION

- Dining tables and chairs
- Tablecloths (and silence pads/molleton, if available)
- Linen Napkins (starched)
- **Crockery:** Service plates (Chargers), Side plates
- **Cutlery:** Main knives & forks, Fish knives & forks, Soup spoons, Dessert spoons & forks, Side knives
- **Glassware:** Water goblets, Wine glasses

PART 1: PRACTICAL DEMONSTRATION OF NAPKIN FOLDS

- The instructor will demonstrate, and students will follow along.
- **Fold 1: The Pyramid.** (Review from Week 10). Focus on clean lines and a stable base.
- **Fold 2: The Fan (in a glass).** Focus on sharp, even pleats.
- **Fold 3: The Bishop's Hat.** Focus on the complex tucks.
- **Practice:** Students will spend time practicing these three folds until they can be done quickly and neatly.

PART 2: PLACEMENT OF TABLE WARES (LAYING THE COVER)

This is a demonstration of the *professional sequence* of setting a full *Table d'Hôte* cover for a 3-course meal (e.g., Soup, Fish, Dessert).

SEQUENCE OF LAYING:

1. **THE LINEN:**
 - Place the **Silence Pad** (molleton) on the table (if used).

- Lay the **Tablecloth**. Demonstrate the "folding" technique to spread it without flapping it (which is unhygienic). Ensure the "crease" is in the center and the overhang is even on all sides.
- 2. **THE CENTERPIECE & PLATE:**
 - Place the **Service Plate (Charger)** in the center of the cover, **one inch** from the edge of the table. (This acts as the "anchor" for the setting).
- 3. **THE CUTLERY:**
 - Work from the **Inside-Out**, placing items one inch from the table edge.
 - **Right Side:**
 - Place the **Fish Knife** (for the 2nd course).
 - Place the **Soup Spoon** (for the 1st course) to the *outside* of the knife.
 - **Left Side:**
 - Place the **Fish Fork** (for the 2nd course).
 - *Note: We are working from the "Outside-In" for the guest, so the Soup Spoon (1st course) is outermost.*
- 4. **THE TOP CUTLERY:**
 - Place the **Dessert Spoon** horizontally *above* the charger, with its **handle pointing to the right**.
 - Place the **Dessert Fork** horizontally *below* the spoon, with its **handle pointing to the left**.
- 5. **THE SIDE PLATE:**
 - Place the **Side Plate** to the **top left** of the cover.
 - Place the **Side Knife** (butter knife) on the right side of the side plate, blade facing left.
- 6. **THE GLASSWARE:**
 - Place the **Water Goblet** at the **top right**, directly above the tip of the main knife.
 - Place the **Wine Glass** to the right of the water goblet.
- 7. **THE NAPKIN:**
 - Take the practiced, folded napkin (e.g., The Bishop's Hat or Pyramid).
 - Place it carefully in the **center** of the Service Plate.

Final Check: The demonstrator will use a ruler or a plate to check that all items are perfectly aligned and symmetrical.

EVALUATION

1. This week's evaluation is **PRACTICAL**. Students will be asked to:
 - (a) Correctly fold one "Pyramid" and one "Fan" napkin.
 - (b) Lay a complete *Table d'Hôte* cover for a 3-course meal.
2. What is the "one-inch rule" in table setting?
3. In what *order* should you place the cutlery for a meal of (1st) Fish and (2nd) Beef?
4. Where is the water goblet placed?
5. What is the purpose of a "Service Plate" or "Charger" during the setup?

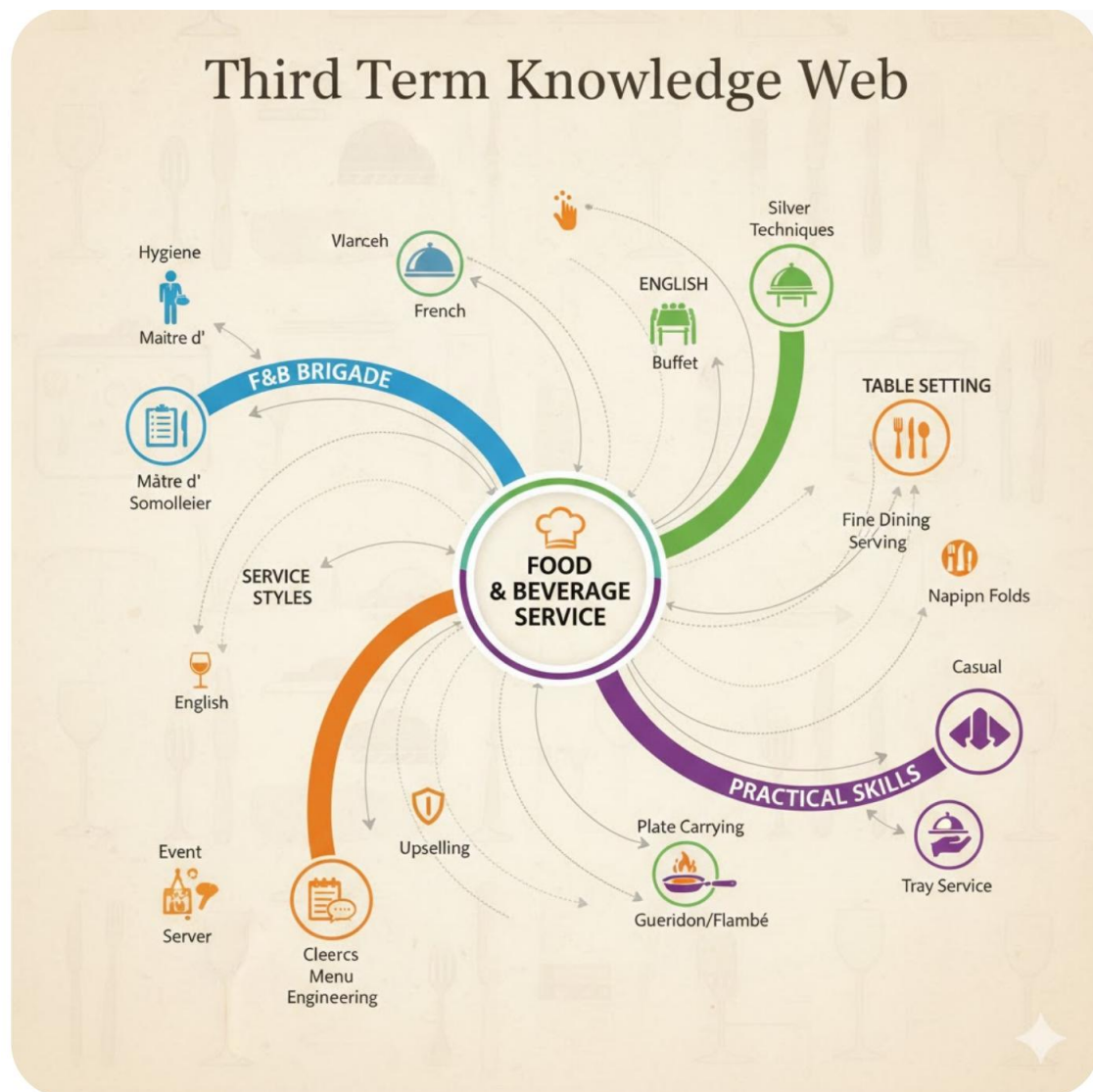
ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Set a full, formal *Table d'Hôte* cover at home. Take a photo and label all 10+ items.
2. Draw a complete, birds-eye-view diagram of the cover you set, labeling every item.
3. Research and write a 150-word report on the "History of the Fork." (When did it become a common dining tool?).
4. Create a checklist of 10 "Dos and Don'ts" for table setting. (e.g., "Do: Wash hands before touching linen," "Don't: Touch the tines of the fork").
5. Why is it important for all covers in a restaurant to be identical?

WEEK 12: REVISION

GENERAL REVIEW OF THE THIRD TERM'S TOPICS

This week is dedicated to a full review of the Third Term's work, which focused entirely on the **Food & Beverage Service** (the *Front-of-House*).



KEY TOPICS REVIEW

- **WEEK 2 & 3: THE F&B BRIGADE (HIERARCHY & PERSONNEL)**
 - We defined the *Brigade de Salle* (Restaurant Brigade).

- **Management:** We detailed the roles of the **F&B Manager** (manages *all* F&B outlets, focuses on finance and strategy) and the **Restaurant Manager** (manages *one* outlet, handles guests and staff).
- **Specialist Staff:** We defined the **Sommelier** (wine expert) and the **Mixologist** (cocktail creator).
- **Operational Staff:** We differentiated the **Head/Station Waiter** (*Chef de Rang* - takes orders, does skilled service) from the **Junior Waiter** (*Commis de Rang* - fetches, carries, clears).

- **WEEK 4 & 6: TYPES OF FOOD SERVICE**

- We analyzed the 6 main styles of service and their "Pros and Cons":
1. **Plate (American):** Plated in the kitchen. (Fast, good control).
 2. **Family (English):** Guests serve themselves from platters. (Social, high waste).
 3. **Cafeteria:** Guests served *by staff* at a counter. (Fast, institutional).
 4. **Self-Service (Buffet):** Guests serve *themselves* from a table. (High choice, high waste).
 5. **Silver Service:** Waiter serves from a platter onto the guest's plate *at the table* using a spoon and fork. (Formal, skilled).
 6. **Guéridon (French):** Food is cooked/finished *at the table* on a trolley. (Luxury, slow, high "showmanship").

- **WEEK 9: TABLE COVER**

- We defined a **Cover** as the place setting for one guest.
- We identified the 4 **Table Wares:** Crockery, Cutlery, Glassware, Linen.
- We established the **General Rules of Laying** (Forks left, Knives right, Blade in, 1-inch rule, etc.).
- We contrasted the **À la Carte Cover** (basic) with the **Table d'Hôte Cover** (all cutlery set in advance, "outside-in").

- **WEEK 10: NAPKIN FOLDING**

- We defined the **purpose** (aesthetics, hygiene, function).
- We differentiated **Linen** (starched, for complex folds) vs. **Paper** (simple folds).
- We practiced key folds: **Pyramid, Bishop's Hat, and Fan.**

- **WEEK 8 & 11: PRACTICALS**

- We put all the theory into practice by demonstrating service styles and laying full covers.

EVALUATION

1. Differentiate between the roles of a *Chef de Rang* and a *Commis de Rang*.
2. Compare and contrast **Silver Service** with **Plate Service**. (Mention who plates the food, staff skill, and speed).
3. What is the "Outside-In" rule of table setting, and for which type of cover is it used?
4. What is the main difference between **Cafeteria Service** and **Buffet Service**?
5. Why is it important to starch a linen napkin?

FINAL TERM ASSIGNMENT

1. **Project:** Design a 3-course *Table d'Hôte* menu for a formal event (e.g., a graduation).
 - (a) Write the menu clearly.
 - (b) State which *service style* you would use (e.g., Plate, Silver).
 - (c) Draw a complete, labeled diagram of the **table cover** that would be required for *your* menu.
 - (d) Name the *napkin fold* you would use.
2. Write a 250-word essay on "The Role of the Restaurant Manager in Handling a Guest Complaint."
3. Create a study guide (e.g., flashcards or a mind map) for all 6 service styles, listing their key features, pros, and cons.
4. Research and write a 150-word report on the "History of the Restaurant."
5. Define the following 10 key terms: F&B Manager, Sommelier, Mixologist, Guéridon, Silver Service, Plate Service, Cafeteria Service, Cover, Crockery, Cutlery.